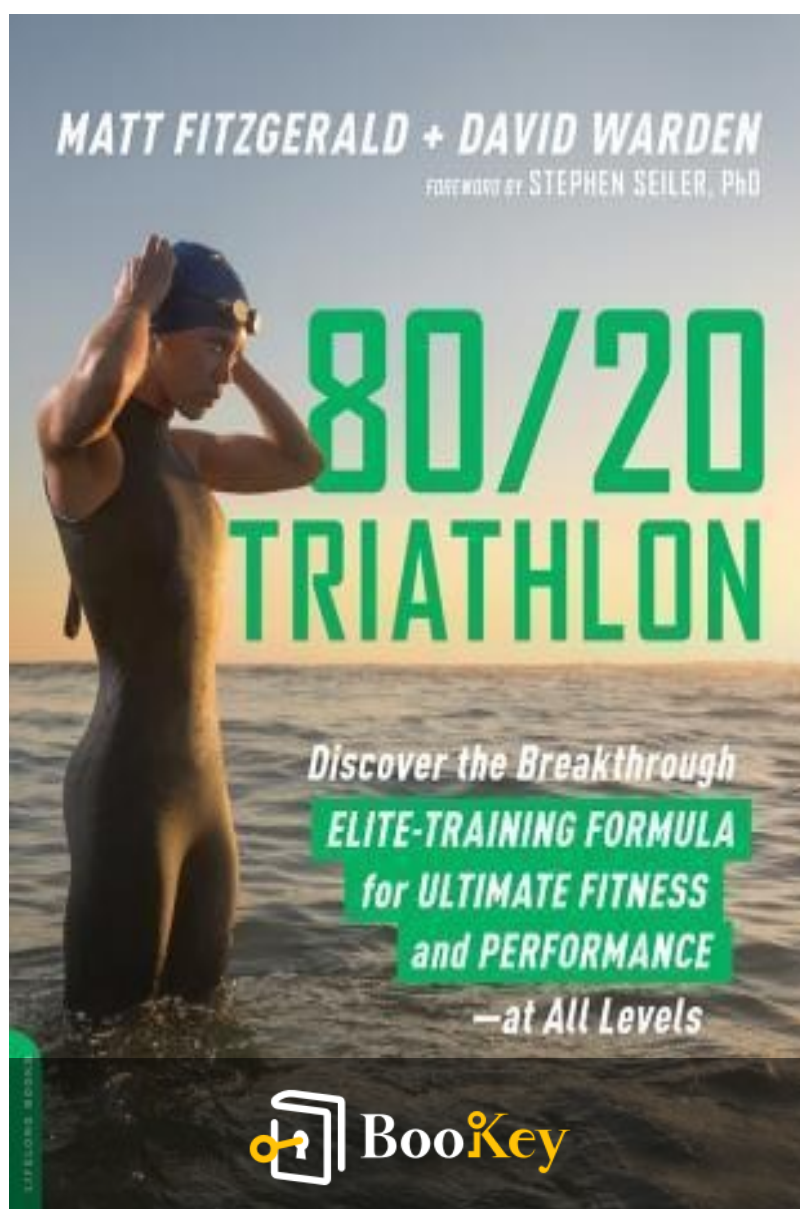


# 80/20 Triathlon PDF

Matt Fitzgerald



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# 80/20 Triathlon

Transform Your Triathlon Training with the 80/20  
Intensity Principle.

Written by Bookey

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## About the book

Unlock your triathlon potential with "80/20 Triathlon," a transformative guide by fitness expert Matt Fitzgerald and elite coach David Warden. This comprehensive program reveals the groundbreaking principle that optimizing performance hinges on balancing training intensity: 80 percent should be at low intensity, while 20 percent is at moderate to high intensity. Many recreational triathletes fall into the common trap of excessive moderate training, which leads to fatigue and diminished results. Supported by cutting-edge research, this book provides actionable strategies and complete training plans tailored to every distance—Sprint, Olympic, Half-Ironman, and Ironman. Embrace the 80/20 rule to experience reduced fatigue, lower injury risk, enhanced fitness, increased motivation, and improved race outcomes.

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## About the author

Matt Fitzgerald is a renowned author, endurance sports coach, and seasoned athlete, recognized for his innovative approaches to training and performance optimization. With a background that spans over two decades in the fitness and nutrition industry, he has written more than 20 books focusing on running, triathlon, and sports psychology, integrating scientific research with practical insights. Fitzgerald's expertise is complemented by his personal experiences as a competitive athlete, making his advice both credible and relatable. He is a regular contributor to health and fitness publications, where he shares his knowledge on nutrition, training strategies, and mental toughness, inspiring athletes of all levels to achieve their personal bests. In "80/20 Triathlon," Fitzgerald combines his passion for triathlon with the effective 80/20 training methodology, advocating for a balanced approach that enhances performance while prioritizing overall well-being.

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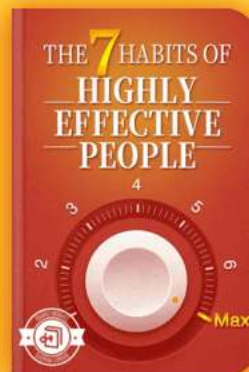
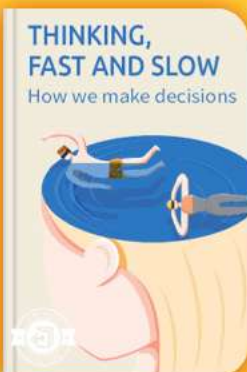


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# Chapter 1 Summary : 1 The Most Effective Way to Train



| Section                         | Summary                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Most Effective Way to Train | Training for a triathlon requires a focus on specific methods regarding training volume and intensity, involving specificity, volume, and intensity as key components for an effective strategy.                                  |
| The 80/20 Rule                  | The 80/20 Rule, established by Stephen Seiler, indicates that elite athletes spend 80% of their training at low intensity and 20% at moderate to high intensities, a practice often neglected by recreational triathletes.        |
| Intensity Blindness             | Athletes may misjudge their training intensities and inadvertently train too hard. Recognizing the ventilatory threshold is essential to avoid fatigue and enhance recovery.                                                      |
| Train Easier, Race Faster       | Triathlete Billy Hafferty exemplifies the 80/20 principle's effectiveness, having shifted to an 80/20 training regimen which greatly improved his performance and race times.                                                     |
| The Way Forward                 | The book provides triathletes with knowledge and tools for 80/20 training, addressing barriers, offering practical strategies for swimming, cycling, running, and presenting training plans to enhance performance and enjoyment. |

## The Most Effective Way to Train

Training for a triathlon is best accomplished through methods specific to the sport, which focus on training

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volume and intensity. Each variable—specificity, volume, and intensity—plays a crucial role in developing an effective training strategy.

## **The 80/20 Rule**

Research by Stephen Seiler has established the 80/20 Rule as a cornerstone of optimal endurance training. Elite athletes consistently train approximately 80% of their time at low intensity, with only 20% at moderate and high intensities. However, many recreational triathletes fail to adhere to this principle, often getting caught in a "moderate-intensity rut" that hampers their performance.

## **Intensity Blindness**

Athletes often misjudge their training intensities, inadvertently training at higher levels than necessary. Understanding and recognizing the ventilatory threshold (VT) is vital, as training slightly above this threshold can lead to accumulated fatigue and hinder recovery.

## **Train Easier, Race Faster**

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An example of the effectiveness of the 80/20 principle is the transformation of triathlete Billy Hafferty, who shifted from a higher intensity training regimen to an 80/20 program, ultimately achieving significant improvements in performance and race times.

## **The Way Forward**

This book aims to equip triathletes with the knowledge and tools necessary to embrace 80/20 training. It will address common barriers to this approach, offer practical application strategies for swimming, cycling, and running, and provide custom and ready-made training plans. Embracing the 80/20 method promises to enhance overall performance, recovery, and enjoyment in the sport.

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## Example

**Key Point:** Embrace the 80/20 training principle for superior performance.

**Example:** Imagine yourself becoming a better triathlete simply by adjusting your training focus—spending 80% of your time on low-intensity endurance sessions.

Picture those long, relaxed runs where you can comfortably chat with a friend, gradually building your aerobic base without the burnout of constant high-intensity efforts. While the thrill of pushing hard might tempt you, remember that this approach ensures you're not only performing at your best but also recovering adequately, enabling you to race faster on race day. By making this shift, you'll witness a remarkable transformation as your endurance improves and your times drop, all while enjoying the journey of training.

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## Critical Thinking

**Key Point:** The 80/20 Rule in triathlon training emphasizes the balance of training intensity and its impact on performance.

**Critical Interpretation:** While Matt Fitzgerald's assertion that the 80/20 Rule is essential for triathlon training is compelling, one must critically examine the generalized application of this principle across different athletic populations. Anecdotal successes, like that of Billy Hafferty, highlight its potential, yet they do not account for individual differences in physiology, training backgrounds, or personal responses to various intensities. Some athletes might find that a different ratio better suits their specific needs or goals, as supported by research indicating variability in training responses. Additionally, writers such as John Howard have argued for the necessity of flexibility in training regimes, suggesting that strict adherence to any rule should be evaluated within the context of individual performance metrics and recovery rates.

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# Chapter 2 Summary : 2 Going Slower to Get Faster



## Going Slower to Get Faster

In 2012, exercise physiologist Iñigo Mujika studied elite triathlete Ainhua Murúa's training, revealing she spent 83% of her training below the lactate threshold, epitomizing the 80/20 Rule, which emphasizes maintaining a majority of training at low intensity. This approach proved successful, as Murúa qualified for the London Olympics.

Most elite triathletes currently follow this intensity balance, while recreational triathletes often struggle, as shown in a similar study where participants spent less than 70% of their training below the ventilatory threshold, leading to minimal

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performance improvement due to a "moderate-intensity rut."

## **The Evolution of 80/20 Training**

The 80/20 training approach has gained prominence due to competition among athletes seeking effective methods to enhance fitness for success in races. Historical analysis shows elite triathletes progressively gravitated toward effective techniques, leading to a widespread adoption of the 80/20 Rule.

Initial training methods involved high volume and intensity, which were later criticized for leading to fatigue and injury. Nevertheless, elite athletes transitioned to a lower intensity approach, evidenced by Mark Allen's success after embracing low-intensity training.

## **Overcoming Barriers to 80/20 Training**

Recreational triathletes face various challenges in adopting the 80/20 principle. Eight common barriers include:

1.

### **Smaller Low-Intensity Range**

: Recreational athletes have a narrower low-intensity range due to lower fitness levels, complicating adherence to the

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necessary training intensity.

2.

### **Lower Volume**

: Elite triathletes can train more due to effective recovery, while recreational athletes risk injury with excessive intensity at low volumes.

3.

### **Lack of Good Coaching**

: Many recreational triathletes receive inadequate coaching that neglects the 80/20 philosophy.

4.

### **Lack of Buy-In**

: Skepticism about the slow training approach leads to resistance among recreational athletes.

5.

### **Ego**

: Competitive nature drives athletes to push harder even on easy days, undermining slower training benefits.

6.

### **Natural-Pace Compromise**

: Athletes often unconsciously settle at a preferred pace, which may place them above the proper training intensity.

7.

### **Intensity Blindness**

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: Many athletes misjudge training intensity, leading to an imbalance.

8.

### **Habit Inertia**

: Former training habits are difficult to change, causing athletes to push harder than advised.

### **The Week of Slow**

A key strategy to transition into the 80/20 training method is to embrace the "week of slow," where athletes focus solely on low-intensity workouts. This five-fold approach recalibrates effort perceptions, dismantles habitual training intensity, and provides initial exposure to 80/20 training benefits.

Following a well-structured week allows athletes to better understand their intensity levels, develop a routine around low-intensity training, and prepare for effective integration of the 80/20 training philosophy into their programs.

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## Example

**Key Point:** Understanding the importance of low-intensity training for performance enhancement

**Example:** Imagine you're a passionate triathlete who pushes your limits every single training session, believing that harder is always better. Now, picture yourself intentionally slowing down for a week—embracing easy runs and relaxed swims. You may feel a sense of frustration initially, but as the days go by, you start to notice an improvement in your endurance. Your body is recovering, and you feel rejuvenated, ready to tackle higher intensity efforts soon after. This week of slow isn't just a break; it's a transformative experience that helps you grasp the essence of the 80/20 principle, ultimately allowing you to race faster, not just through sheer effort but through smart, effective training.

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# Chapter 3 Summary : 3 The Science of 80/20 Training

| Section                                 | Summary                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introduction to 80/20 Training          | The 80/20 training model balances intensity similarly to elite endurance athletes, proving effective for all levels, emphasizing how slowing down improves performance.                                 |
| The Recipe for Endurance Fitness        | Triathlon training consists of 80% low-intensity and 20% combined moderate and high-intensity workouts, correcting the misconception that high-intensity training is the only option for fitness gains. |
| Low Intensity Workouts                  | Low-intensity training (60-77% max heart rate) enhances aerobic capacity, fat utilization, fatigue resistance, and technique improvement, crucial for endurance athletes.                               |
| Moderate Intensity Workouts             | Moderate-intensity workouts (78-92% max heart rate) help athletes adapt to race speeds and improve efficiency relevant to competition pacing.                                                           |
| High Intensity Workouts                 | High-intensity training is important for maximizing aerobic capacity and should be limited in volume due to its high stress, aiding in metabolic adaptations.                                           |
| Optimal Ratios and Effects of Intensity | Effective training balances primarily low-intensity work with small portions of moderate and high-intensity, avoiding overtraining while promoting endurance fitness gains.                             |
| Evidence Supporting the 80/20 Approach  | Research shows historical and interventional evidence supporting the 80/20 model, with athletes performing better when adhering closely to this training distribution.                                  |
| Conclusion on Intensity Distribution    | Combining moderate and high-intensity workouts should constitute about 20% of total training time, with low-intensity work being essential for endurance training.                                      |

## The Science of 80/20 Training

### Introduction to 80/20 Training

While not created by scientists, the 80/20 training model, which emphasizes an intensity balance favored by elite endurance athletes, has been proven to yield superior results

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for athletes at all levels. This chapter aims to clarify the effectiveness of the 80/20 approach, especially for those who struggle to understand how slowing down can enhance triathlon performance.

## **The Recipe for Endurance Fitness**

Triathlon training can be likened to baking a cake, where different intensities of workouts are the ingredients. To optimize fitness gains, training should consist of 80% low-intensity and a combined 20% moderate and high-intensity workouts. The media often elevates high-intensity training above the others, overlooking the essential roles all three intensities play in enhancing fitness.

### **Low Intensity Workouts**

Low-intensity training (60-77% of maximum heart rate)

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# Chapter 4 Summary : 4 Swimming the 80/20 Way

| Section                         | Summary                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Swimming the 80/20 Way          | Swimming is challenging for many triathletes, but significant improvements can be made with focused training. The 80/20 approach involves 80% of training at low intensity and 20% at moderate to high intensity, requiring personalization based on individual intensity zones. |
| Lactate Threshold Determination | Lactate threshold (LT) is the intensity at which lactate builds up, indicating the highest sustainable effort for about 60 minutes. Field tests can estimate LT through heart rate and pace, helping swimmers set personal intensity zones.                                      |
| 80/20 Swim Intensity Zones      | Based on LTSP, swimmers establish personalized intensity zones across a seven-zone scale, including very low intensity (Zone 1) to high-intensity training (Zone 5) while avoiding moderate intensity (Zone X) that can be counterproductive.                                    |
| Creating Swim Zones             | Swimmers determine their swim zones by calculating percentages of their LTSP, with recalibration recommended every three to six weeks as fitness levels evolve.                                                                                                                  |
| 80/20 Swim Workouts             | Effective 80/20 training involves a strategic mix of different intensities rather than strict ratios within a single workout. Key components include duration, intensity, and structure for optimal training plans.                                                              |
| Technique and Drills            | Swimming efficiency is improved through technique. Drills using snorkels, fins, swim golf, and specific strokes enhance skills and complement physical fitness training.                                                                                                         |
| Group Swimming Considerations   | Group swim classes can motivate triathletes but must be balanced with personal intensity goals to maintain the 80/20 approach. Hard group workouts should be paired with recovery swims.                                                                                         |

## Swimming the 80/20 Way

Swimming is a key barrier for many potential triathletes. While running and biking are often more comfortable for athletes, swimming presents a unique challenge. However, being a weaker swimmer can lead to substantial improvements through focused training. The 80/20 approach emphasizes doing 80% of swimming training at low intensity

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and 20% at moderate to high intensity. To effectively implement this, swimmers need to define their personal intensity zones based on factors like ventilatory and lactate thresholds.

## **Lactate Threshold Determination**

Lactate threshold (LT) is the intensity level at which lactate begins to accumulate in the bloodstream, representing the highest sustainable effort for approximately 60 minutes. While direct testing of blood lactate levels can be challenging, there are field tests to indirectly identify LT through pace and heart rate monitoring. The lactate threshold swim pace (LTSP) can be ascertained using various methods, including a critical velocity protocol or a timed 1,000-yard swim. This information allows swimmers to establish personalized intensity zones for their training.

## **80/20 Swim Intensity Zones**

Once LTSP is identified, swimmers can calculate a set of individualized intensity zones. The 80/20 intensity model utilizes a seven-zone scale to guide training efforts:

-

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### **Zone 1:**

Very low intensity for warm-ups and recovery.

-

### **Zone 2:**

Low intensity where endurance training occurs; focuses on fat burning.

-

### **Zone X:**

A moderate intensity that often becomes a trap for athletes, should be avoided for optimal training.

-

### **Zone 3:**

Corresponds to lactate threshold, essential for performance improvement.

-

### **Zone Y:**

Low utility zone not specifically targeted in typical workouts.

-

### **Zone 4:**

High-intensity training vital for developing aerobic power.

-

### **Zone 5:**

Focuses on developing speed and efficiency through short,

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intense intervals.

## **Creating Swim Zones**

Swimmers can create their unique swim zones by calculating percentages of their current LTSP. As fitness levels change, recalculating these zones is necessary, ideally every three to six weeks.

## **80/20 Swim Workouts**

80/20 training isn't simply about maintaining ratios in individual workouts but mixing different types of intensity-focused workouts strategically. Individual swim workouts consist of three primary components: duration, intensity, and structure. Properly combining these elements leads to an effective training plan.

## **Technique and Drills**

Technique is crucial for swimming performance. Several drills, such as using snorkels or fins, swim golf, and specific stroke techniques, can enhance efficiency and reduce drag in the water. Practicing these drills regularly strengthens

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swimming skills and complements fitness training.

## Group Swimming Considerations

Participating in group swim classes, like those within the United States Masters Swimming, can provide necessary motivation. However, triathletes should remain mindful of intensity levels during these sessions to avoid overexerting themselves. Balancing hard-group workouts with Recovery or Foundation swims will help maintain the 80/20 training ratios effectively.

By understanding and applying these principles, triathletes can enhance their swimming abilities significantly.

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## Example

**Key Point:** Balance your swim training using the 80/20 approach for optimal improvement.

**Example:** Imagine you're gliding through the water, feeling a tad unsure about your swim skills. You've heard that swimming often trips up triathletes, but you know this is a barrier you can conquer. As you settle into a routine, you start focusing on your training, dedicating four out of five sessions to gentle, low-intensity swimming, feeling the rhythm of your strokes while reinforcing your endurance. Then, once a week, you challenge yourself to push harder, swimming at a brisker pace to build your power and speed. By adhering to this 80/20 method, not only do you notice a gradual boost in your confidence and technique, but you also realize that the key to your swimming success lies not in struggling at high intensity all the time, but in allowing your body the necessary recovery and adaptation time to flourish.

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# Chapter 5 Summary : 5 Cycling the 80/20 Way

## 5 Cycling the 80/20 Way

### Importance of Cycling in Triathlons

Cycling is the most crucial discipline in triathlons, often taking up more time than swimming and running combined. A strong cycling performance not only improves bike splits but also enhances running performance by preserving energy for the run.

### Applying the 80/20 Rule

To maximize cycling fitness and enjoyment, apply the 80/20 Rule, focusing on balanced training. The first step is to determine your intensity zones through lactate threshold testing, which can be measured using heart rate or power metrics.

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## Heart Rate Testing and Lactate Threshold

Lactate Threshold Heart Rate (LTHR) testing can be done via a 30-minute time trial to find your heart rate at which lactate begins to accumulate. This process involves warming up, maintaining a high effort for 30 minutes, and capturing average heart rate for the last 20 minutes.

### Alternative LTHR Testing

As an alternative to the time trial, an easier method involves working up to your highest effort level for 30 minutes and noting when your heart rate plateaus, which approximates your LTHR.

### Limitations of Heart Rate Measurement

Heart rate can be influenced by various factors (e.g., temperature, hydration), making it less reliable than power metrics. Testing under similar conditions to your typical training environment will yield the best results.

### Functional Threshold Power (FTP)

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Power is a more accurate measure of cycling output, allowing for less variability due to environmental factors. Establishing your Functional Threshold Power (FTP) involves a similar protocol to LTHR testing, focusing on the average power output over a 30-minute effort.

## **Calculating 80/20 Cycling Zones**

Once LTHR or FTP is established, cyclists can calculate specific cycling zones for training. Retesting every three to six weeks helps adapt these zones based on current fitness levels.

## **Perceived Effort (RPE) as an Alternative**

The Rating of Perceived Effort (RPE) scale allows athletes to gauge intensity without devices. This subjective measure should be calibrated against objective metrics to improve accuracy.

## **80/20 Cycling Workouts**

Every cycling workout contributes to overall fitness. Understanding the format of workouts, including durations

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and intensities, allows athletes to execute them correctly.

## **Cadence and Pedaling Technique**

Cadence—typically between 75-95 rpm—is crucial for efficiency. Aiming for an optimal cadence of about 90 rpm helps delay fatigue and conserves glycogen stores, essential for endurance athletes.

By incorporating these principles into training, triathletes can significantly enhance their cycling performance, thereby improving overall race outcomes.

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## Critical Thinking

**Key Point:** Importance of Method Selection in Endurance Training

**Critical Interpretation:** Fitzgerald emphasizes using the 80/20 rule and specific metrics like LTHR and FTP to optimize cycling performance in triathlons, suggesting a focus on structured and measurable training. However, this method might not suit every athlete; subjective measures such as perceived effort (RPE) can vary widely in reliability and effectiveness. Moreover, contrary studies indicate that simplicity and enjoyment in training can lead to sustained motivation and performance improvements (refer to "Endurance Sports Nutrition" by Susan M. Kleiner). Thus, readers should critically evaluate whether strict adherence to such metrics truly maximizes their performance or if a more intuitive approach could yield better results.

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# Chapter 6 Summary : 6 Running the 80/20 Way

## Running the 80/20 Way

Running is more challenging than swimming or cycling, but it is essential for successful triathlon racing. A strong running performance is common among successful triathlons.

Humans are biologically adapted for distance running, and inefficient intensity distribution is a major barrier to improvement.

## Lactate Threshold Heart Rate

To optimize running performance, conduct a field test to determine your lactate threshold heart rate (LTHR). The running LTHR can differ from cycling LTHR and should be tested separately. This involves a structured test where you maintain a high pace for 30 minutes and record your average heart rate.

## Threshold Pace

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Running pace is a viable metric since aerodynamic drag affects cycling differently. To find your threshold pace (TP), perform a similar 30-minute test, measuring how far you can run and calculating your average pace. Alternatives for estimating TP are also available.

## **Power Monitoring for Running**

Recent advancements have made it possible to measure running power, similar to cycling. This is done using power meters that provide a more accurate intensity measure unaffected by weather and terrain. Like LTHR, a 30-minute running power test can help determine functional threshold power (FTP).

### **80/20 Run Zones**

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# Chapter 7 Summary : 7 Strength, Flexibility, and Mobility Training

## 7. Strength, Flexibility, and Mobility Training

### Introduction to Triathlon Fitness

Triathlon requires stamina and speed, but it also demands strength, flexibility, and mobility. Training these aspects alongside swimming, cycling, and running can enhance performance and reduce injury risks.

### Importance of Strength Training

Strength training increases muscle force capacity, improves running efficiency, and helps prevent common overuse injuries.

### Understanding Mobility and Flexibility

-

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## **Mobility**

refers to how efficiently joints can move through their full range of motion, enhancing swimming, cycling, and running.

-

## **Flexibility**

is the passive range of motion of joints. Many triathletes experience limited flexibility due to muscle tightness from long periods of sitting or specific training positions.

## **Challenges in Training**

Finding time for strength, mobility, and flexibility training can be tough for athletes with busy schedules. However, it is necessary, and a pragmatic approach can make it feasible without major lifestyle changes.

## **Optional Training Plans**

The strength, flexibility, and mobility exercises discussed are not included in the main training plans, allowing athletes to opt-out if time is limited. Successful triathletes may or may not include these in their routines, but benefits are significant.

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## At-Home Strength Workout

-

### Equipment Needed

: Stability ball, exercise bench, medicine ball or dumbbells.

-

### Frequency

: Twice per week.

- Begin with one set per exercise, progressing gradually to two or three sets based on capacity and time.

### Example Exercises

1. Side Step-Up
2. Stick Crunch
3. Scapular Push-Up
4. Stability Ball Hamstring Curl
5. Side Plank
6. Eccentric Heel Dip
7. Stability Ball Trunk Rotation

## Gym-Based Strength Workout

-

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## Equipment Needed

: Dumbbells, cables, stability ball, kettlebells, chin-up bar.

-

## Frequency

: Twice per week.

- Follow similar progressive set approaches as the at-home workout.

## Mobility and Flexibility Training Routine

-

## Frequency

: At least twice per week, ideally daily.

- Consist of mobility routines that can be incorporated into warm-ups before swimming or cycling.

## Summary of Exercises

Includes stretches and mobility exercises targeting major muscle groups like calves, hips, chest, and shoulders, each designed to enhance joint function and muscle flexibility.

## Conclusion

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Incorporating strength, flexibility, and mobility training into triathlon preparations boosts performance while mitigating injury risks. Maintaining a balanced approach can lead to significant benefits in overall athletic capability.

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# Chapter 8 Summary : 8 Getting Started with 80/20 Training

| Section                                          | Summary                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introduction to Effective Training               | A structured training plan is essential for triathlon training, enhancing fitness and performance through adherence to the 80/20 Rule.                      |
| Creating Your Training Plan                      | Understanding training design fundamentals is beneficial for all athletes to customize their training plans when necessary.                                 |
| Step 1: Define Your Training Cycle               | A training cycle of 12-24 weeks should align with race schedules, including necessary recovery breaks, tailored to the athlete's experience and race goals. |
| Step 2: Schedule Recovery Weeks                  | Incorporate recovery weeks every 3-4 weeks, reducing training load to prevent fatigue and injuries, ideally aligning these with race days.                  |
| Step 3: Create a Default Weekly Workout Schedule | Weekly workouts should balance swim, bike, and run sessions, starting with two of each discipline and gradually increasing frequency.                       |
| Step 4: Plan Your Peak Training Step Cycle       | Identify the peak training phase with the highest workloads and race-specific workouts to ensure manageable progressions.                                   |
| Step 5: Plan Your First Training Week            | The first week should slightly increase the training challenge, following the 80/20 rule according to race preparation.                                     |
| Step 6: Fill in the Rest of Your Schedule        | Progressively increase challenge levels in training while keeping recovery weeks, monitoring adjustments to sustain optimal performance growth.             |
| Conclusion: Embrace Flexibility                  | Training plan design is flexible; learning from each cycle's feedback is key to improving future performance.                                               |

## 8 Getting Started with 80/20 Training

### Introduction to Effective Training

Effective triathlon training necessitates a well-structured plan, regardless of whether the athlete is new or experienced.

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Following a training plan enhances improvements in fitness and performance compared to unstructured training. Understanding the principles behind the 80/20 Rule and general training practices is crucial in plan design.

## **Creating Your Training Plan**

Most triathletes prefer ready-made training plans provided by experts. However, understanding the fundamentals of training design can benefit all athletes, especially when modifications are needed due to fatigue or soreness. This chapter outlines six steps to create a custom 80/20 triathlon training plan.

### **Step 1: Define Your Training Cycle**

A training cycle spans 12 to 24 weeks, aligning with race schedules. It's vital to take breaks post-training cycles for recovery. The length of the training cycle should depend on the athlete's fitness level, race distance, and the number of races planned. Strategies vary between athletes who focus on one major race and those who compete frequently over a season.

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## **Step 2: Schedule Recovery Weeks**

Recovery weeks are essential to allow athletes to catch up with rest. Every third or fourth week should be scheduled as a recovery week, reducing the training load to handle heavier training loads effectively and minimize fatigue and injury risk. Race days should align with recovery weeks whenever possible.

## **Step 3: Create a Default Weekly Workout Schedule**

Weekly workout schedules, or microcycles, should include equal distributions of swim, bike, and run sessions. A baseline of two sessions per discipline weekly is recommended, gradually increasing exercise frequency while maintaining a balance across disciplines. The goal is to distribute workouts evenly throughout the week.

## **Step 4: Plan Your Peak Training Step Cycle**

Identifying the peak step cycle, characterized by the heaviest workloads, is crucial for race preparation. This planning sets benchmarks for workload progression during the training cycle. Focus on race-specific workouts and ensure that the

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overall training load is manageable and progressive.

### **Step 5: Plan Your First Training Week**

The first week of training is significant for setting the right trajectory towards the peak step cycle. Maintain a slight increase in training challenge compared to previous weeks, and apply the 80/20 rule judiciously based on the specific race preparation.

### **Step 6: Fill in the Rest of Your Schedule**

Finalize the plan by ensuring that each week becomes progressively more challenging while retaining scheduled recovery periods. Monitor and adjust the training workload incrementally to maintain an optimal progression towards peak performance.

### **Conclusion: Embrace Flexibility**

Training plan design is not an exact science, and there is no perfect plan. Variability in training can yield equally effective results. Continuously learn and adjust based on feedback from previous training cycles to improve future performance effectively.

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# Chapter 9 Summary : 9 Introduction to 80/20 Training Plans

## Chapter 9: Introduction to 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans

This chapter outlines the general guidelines applicable to the various training plans provided for different triathlon distances: sprint, Olympic, half Ironman, and Ironman.

### Key Guidelines:

-

### Workout Scheduling:

- Some plans feature two workouts in one day, which can be executed back-to-back or separately (morning and evening).
- For back-to-back workouts, complete the swim first.
- If a bike and run are scheduled on the same day, start with the more intense workout. If both are similar in intensity, begin with the weaker discipline.

-

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## Rest Days:

- Monday is generally a rest day, but swim workouts can be moved to this day for convenience.
- You can combine two swim workouts into a single session to minimize days with double workouts.
- 

## Open Water Swimming:

- If your event includes an open-water swim, try to do at least one swim per week in open water or with a wetsuit during the final four weeks.
- 

## Intensity Distribution:

- Each training plan indicates the distribution of low versus moderate/high intensity for the week.
- The shaded rows in the plans differentiate between weeks

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# **Chapter 10 Summary : 10 80/20**

## **Triathlon Training Plans: Sprint Distance**

### **80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Sprint Distance**

#### **Importance of Sprint Distance**

- The sprint triathlon provides an excellent return on investment for athletes, allowing frequent racing and quicker recovery.
- It consists of a 0.5-mile swim, 12-mile bike, and 3-mile run.
- Inexpensive compared to longer events, making it accessible for more athletes, including older and injury-prone individuals.
- Sprint races are intense and typically performed at the upper Zone 3 effort level.

#### **Overview of Sprint Training Plans**

- There are four sprint training plans, ranging from 12 to 19

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weeks.

- The plans start with a general training phase before transitioning into specific training, followed by a taper period.
- All plans conclude with a two-week taper.

## **Training Plans Breakdown**

### **Level 0**

- For beginners aiming to finish their first sprint event.
- Required fitness: swim/run for 30 minutes, cycle for 45 minutes, 3 hours of weekly aerobic exercise.
- Weekly volume: starts at 4 hours (Week 1), peaks at 6.5 hours (Week 8).

### **Level 1**

- Suitable for any triathlete preferring a low-volume training plan.
- Required fitness: swim/run for 45 minutes, cycle for 60 minutes, at least 4 hours of weekly aerobic exercise.
- Weekly volume: starts at 6 hours (Week 1), peaks at 8.5

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hours (Week 13).

## **Level 2**

- Designed for athletes with a specific time goal and prior triathlon experience.
- Required fitness: swim/bike/run for 1 hour.
- Weekly volume: starts at 7.25 hours (Week 1), peaks at 10.25 hours (Week 13).

## **Level 3**

- For serious triathletes aiming for top age group performances.
- Required fitness: strong endurance background, comfortably swim/bike/run for 1 hour.
- Weekly volume: starts at 8.75 hours (Week 1), peaks at 12 hours (Week 13).

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# Chapter 11 Summary : 11 80/20

## Triathlon Training Plans: Olympic Distance

### 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Olympic Distance

The Olympic-distance triathlon (1.5 km swim, 40 km bike, 10 km run) is ideal for well-rounded endurance athletes, offering a balance between speed and endurance. Olympic training prepares athletes for various events, including sprints and half Ironman races. However, the training can be challenging due to the need for high-intensity intervals, volume, and brick workouts. To avoid injury and overtraining, proper intensity balance is crucial, especially in Olympic training.

### Training Plans Overview

There are four Olympic distance training plans, ranging from 16 to 19 weeks. Each plan includes a 12 to 14-week general phase followed by a specific phase and concludes with a two-week taper.

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## Level 0 Plan

- Target: First-time Olympic event finishers
- Prerequisites: Swim/run for 30 mins, cycle for 45 mins, and complete at least 3 hours of aerobic exercise weekly.
- Weekly volume: Starts at 4 hours (Week 1) and peaks at 7.5 hours (Week 11).

## Level 1 Plan

- Target: Low-volume training for beginners or experienced triathletes.
- Prerequisites: Swim/run for 45 mins, cycle for 60 mins, and complete at least 4 hours of aerobic exercise weekly.
- Weekly volume: Starts at 6 hours (Week 1) and peaks at 9.5 hours (Week 11).

## Level 2 Plan

- Target: Athletes aiming for a specific goal time.
- Prerequisites: Previous triathlon completion or strong background in one discipline; swim/bike/run for one hour, with at least 6 hours of weekly aerobic exercise.

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- Weekly volume: Starts at 8.75 hours (Week 1) and peaks at 11.75 hours (Week 13).

### **Level 3 Plan**

- Target: Competitive athletes aiming for top performance in their age group.
- Prerequisites: Previous endurance events completed; swim/run for one hour, cycle for 90 minutes, with at least 6 hours of weekly aerobic exercise.
- Weekly volume: Starts at 9.25 hours (Week 1) and peaks at 13 hours (Week 13).

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# **Chapter 12 Summary : 12 80/20**

## **Triathlon Training Plans: Half Ironman Distance**

### **80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Half Ironman Distance**

#### **Introduction**

The half Ironman is a popular distance for triathletes, often serving as a significant milestone in their journey. It requires serious preparation, as it is a demanding 70.3-mile event that appeals to both newcomers and seasoned athletes.

#### **Training Structure**

There are four half-Ironman training levels, ranging from 18 to 21 weeks in length, consisting of a general phase followed by a specific phase and concluding with a tapering period. Weekend bike and run sessions are designed to simulate race conditions.

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## General Phase

During the general phase, it includes a notable amount of work at higher intensity levels (Zone 3 and above) to enhance speed, power, and aerobic capacity before transitioning to longer, less intense workouts in the specific phase.

## Specific Phase

The specific phase may see the intensity ratio shift closer to 85/15 to accommodate the expected demands during specific workouts.

## Training Levels

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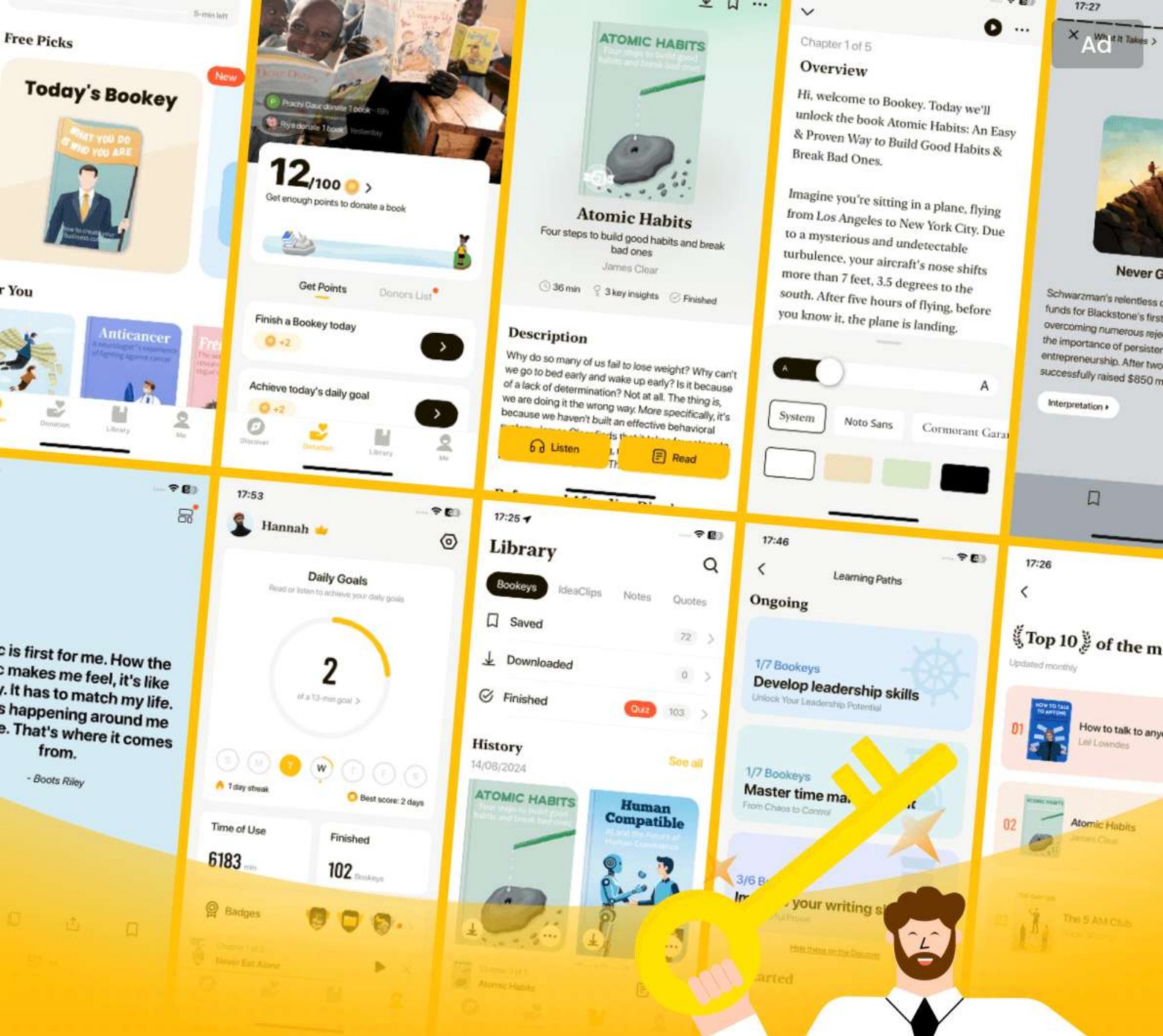


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# **Chapter 13 Summary : 13 80/20**

## **Triathlon Training Plans: Ironman Distance**

### **Chapter 13: 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Ironman Distance**

#### **Introduction to Ironman**

The Ironman distance is a challenging yet enticing goal for many triathletes, first established in 1978. The components of the race—a 2.4-mile swim, 112-mile bike ride, and 26.2-mile run—symbolize both the physical demands and the personal sacrifices involved in Ironman training.

#### **The Ironman Experience**

Completing an Ironman is a significant achievement that many triathletes look back on fondly. Unlike the notion of finishing in defeat, the focus of 80/20 training is on finishing with pride and satisfaction, highlighted by joyful finish line

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photos.

## Training Plans Overview

There are four Ironman training plans designed to accommodate various experience levels, lasting between 21 to 23 weeks. Each plan consists of:

- A general phase of 12 weeks
- A specific phase lasting 7 to 9 weeks
- A 2-week taper

## Training Levels

1.

### Level 0

: For first-time Ironman participants.

- Requirements: Able to swim/run for 45 minutes and cycle for 60 minutes.

- Weekly volume: Starts at 4.75 hours and peaks at 12.5 hours.

2.

### Level 1

: Designed for beginners and experienced athletes seeking a lower-volume option.

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- Requirements: Able to swim/run/cycle for 60 minutes and complete 5 hours of aerobic exercise weekly.

- Weekly volume: Starts at 7.75 hours and peaks at 14 hours.

3.

## **Level 2**

: Suitable for competitive triathletes aiming for personal bests.

- Requirements: Should have completed at least one triathlon and be able to swim/run for an hour and cycle for 2 hours.

- Weekly volume: Starts at 9.5 hours and peaks at 16.25 hours.

4.

## **Level 3**

: For ambitious triathletes ready to commit significant time.

- Requirements: Must have completed several long-distance triathlons; able to swim/run for an hour and cycle for 2 hours.

- Weekly volume: Starts at 10 hours and peaks at 18.75 hours.

## **Conclusion**

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The 80/20 training approach ensures that athletes maximize their training effectiveness while preparing for an Ironman, focusing on completing the event with energy and enjoyment rather than exhaustion.

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# Chapter 14 Summary : 15 Race Day

## Race Day Pacing for Triathletes

### Introduction to Race Questions

Athletes often inquire about the appropriate effort zones for racing and whether to use heart rate or power metrics for guidance. This section elaborates on effective pacing strategies for triathlon races.

### Using Intensity Zones for Racing

-

#### General Use of Intensity Zones

: Intensity zones from training are too broad for race conditions. They are useful for workouts aimed at specific training effects but not for the precise objectives of racing.

-

#### Optimal Pacing Definition

: Pacing is described as the distribution and management of effort throughout a race to achieve the shortest completion

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time.

## **Challenges of Race Pacing**

-

### **Individual Variations**

: Each leg of a triathlon (swim, bike, run) necessitates tailored efforts. Mismanagement can result in insufficient energy reserves for subsequent legs.

-

### **Risks of Intensity Zones**

: Using rough intensity zones may lead to overshooting limits or leaving capacity untapped.

## **Pacing Styles and Strategies**

-

### **Examining Cycling Performance**

: Research shows lower power variation is linked to better performance, indicating the need for consistent pacing.

-

### **Comparison with Standard Events**

: Recommendations for pacing in triathlons should consider performance in standalone events.

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## Steps for Optimal Triathlon Pacing

1.

### **Set Goals**

: First, establish reasonable performance goals for each leg based on past experiences and training sessions.

2.

### **Create a Course-Specific Pacing Plan**

: Analyze the race course, weather conditions, and personal past performance to tailor a pacing plan.

3.

### **Execution Based on Feel**

: While starting with set goals, adaptability using perceived effort is crucial for making real-time adjustments.

## Establishing Swim, Bike, and Run Goals

-

### **Swim Goals**

: Research suggests swimming at 80-85% of max effort can enhance overall race performance.

-

### **Bike Goals**

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: Power-based metrics provide more consistency in pacing across different conditions than speed metrics.

-

## **Run Goals**

: Starting the run at 95% of the best 10K pace is recommended, especially for short-course events. For longer events, adjust expectations based on prior experiences.

## **Development and Improvement of Pacing Skills**

- Understanding perceived effort and its correlation to pacing is vital. This skill develops through experience, making reflection on workouts essential for progression.

-

## **Learning from Experience**

: Each race presents learning opportunities. Mistakes in pacing offer insight into effective strategies for future competitions.

## **Conclusion**

Patently improving the skill of pacing through training and reflective practices will help triathletes refine their execution during races, enabling the pursuit of optimal performance and experiences.

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## Critical Thinking

**Key Point:** The Role of Individual Variation in Triathlon Pacing

**Critical Interpretation:** While the chapter emphasizes tailored pacing strategies for each leg of a triathlon based on intensity zones, considering individual physiological differences may challenge the author's perspective. Research on endurance performance suggests that factors such as the athlete's fitness level, experience, and even psychological aspects can substantially influence optimal pacing (Fitzgerald, M. (2014). '80/20 Triathlon'). Therefore, while a structured approach to pacing is advocated, athletes should critically evaluate and adapt these strategies to fit their unique circumstances. It's important to note that empirical evidence varies, and a flexible approach may yield better results for some, questioning the universality of these strategies.

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# Chapter 15 Summary : Appendix A: 80/20 Swimming Workouts

## APPENDIX A: 80/20 SWIMMING WORKOUTS

### Low-Intensity Swims

Swim Recovery (SRe) workouts are essential for active recovery after intense training, allowing triathletes to recover without a major fitness build. These workouts focus on maintaining a low zone (Zone 1) and can be broken into smaller sessions with rest breaks. Including stroke drills and alternative strokes is encouraged.

### Swim Foundation (SF)

Swim Foundation workouts help maintain the 80/20 intensity balance by involving long, steady efforts that emphasize form and technique. The Zone 2 portion should be continuous, with options to use hand paddles or a pull buoy to improve pulling strength.

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## Swim Aerobic Intervals (SAe)

Designed to allow long distances in Zone 2, these workouts help simulate race pace for events like Ironman races, providing variety to avoid monotony. Training intensity can vary within Zone 2.

## Moderate and High-Intensity Swims

-

### Swim Cruise Interval (SCI)

: A crucial tool for increasing critical velocity, performed in Zone 3 while maintaining good form. Rest time can be adjusted but should not exceed 45 seconds.

-

### Swim Tempo (ST)

: Challenges sustained high intensity over longer distances.

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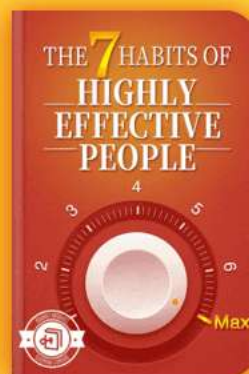
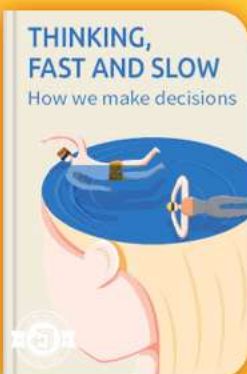


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# Chapter 16 Summary : Appendix B: 80/20 Cycling Workouts

## APPENDIX B: 80/20 CYCLING WORKOUTS

### Overview of High-Intensity Intervals

The aggregate count of high intensity in cycling workouts, including recovery intervals of 3 minutes or less, is important for managing workout intensity.

### Types of Cycling Workouts

#### Low-Intensity Cycling Workouts

-

#### Cycling Recovery (CRe)

: These rides maintain fitness while promoting recovery with a gentle Zone 1 effort. Best performed solo to maintain the required intensity.

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-

### **Cycling Foundation (CF)**

: A foundational workout demanding discipline to maintain Zone 2 intensity. Critical for achieving the 80/20 intensity balance.

-

### **Cycling Aerobic Intervals (CAe)**

: Prepares athletes for the intensity of long-distance races, primarily for those preparing for half or full Ironman events.

## **Moderate and High-Intensity Cycling Workouts**

-

### **Cycling Cruise Intervals (CCI)**

: Improves muscular endurance at a steady Zone 3 output, suitable throughout training cycles.

-

### **Cycling Tempo (CT)**

: Develops endurance and simulates races with long Zone 3 segments. Adjust intensity based on heart rate feedback.

-

### **Cycling Fast Finish (CFF)**

: Incorporates high-intensity efforts at the end of a ride, enhancing the ability to perform on tired legs.

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### **Cycling Force (CFo)**

: Focuses on pedaling efficiency, ensuring a strong output on short uphill intervals. Hills can be simulated if absent.

-

### **Cycling Mixed Intervals (CMI)**

: Increases lactate threshold and aerobic capacity, essential for more intense racing workouts.

-

### **Cycling Anaerobic Intervals (CAn)**

: Enhances VO<sub>2</sub>max and overall movement economy, crucial when integrated effectively.

-

### **Cycling Speed Play (CSP)**

: Features long Zone 4 intervals with shorter recoveries, focusing on pacing and seated positioning.

## **Brick Workouts**

-

### **Brick (BR)**

: Simulates race conditions by alternating between cycling and running with intervals, which helps in mastering transitions and building overall fitness.

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### **Example Workout (BR3)**

: Includes a structured sequence of cycling and running intervals that allows for brief transitions between disciplines. These workouts are designed to optimize endurance and performance for triathletes at various competitive levels, ensuring a structured approach to training that emphasizes both efficiency and effectiveness.

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# Chapter 17 Summary : Appendix C: 80/20 Running Workouts

## APPENDIX C: 80/20 RUNNING WORKOUTS

### Low-Intensity Runs

#### Running Recovery (RRe)

Running Recovery is a gentle jog in Zone 1 that provides minimal aerobic training stimulus without hindering recovery from previous hard workouts. It's crucial to stay in Zone 1 and conserve energy for upcoming intense sessions.

#### Running Foundation (RF)

This basic aerobic run is often performed incorrectly. It should be done slightly below the ventilatory threshold, promoting improvement more than any other workout. Consider it the "vegetables" of training, beneficial for

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long-term performance enhancement.

## **Running Aerobic Intervals (RAe)**

Primarily used in half and full Ironman training, these intervals should be paced according to the expected intensity of upcoming races. New athletes should target the lower end of Zone 2, while advanced competitors may need to reach Zone X for optimal intensity.

## **Moderate and High-Intensity Running Workouts**

### **Running Cruise Intervals (RCI)**

This Zone 3 workout is performed near lactate threshold pace and helps improve speed for triathlon run splits. Adjust rest periods based on previous workouts' success.

### **Running Tempo (RT)**

Simulating sprint and Olympic race intensities, this workout also helps verify lactate threshold through varied testing methods. HR or average pace during efforts can yield

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important thresholds for future training.

## **Running Fast Finish (RFF)**

This workout enhances the ability to run fast while fatigued, crucial for triathletes, often deemed one of the best training sessions available.

## **Running Hill Repeats (RHR)**

Hill repeats build power and efficiency in stride. Because efforts are brief, pace or perceived effort is used to gauge intensity, rather than heart rate. Lacking access to hills? Use a treadmill with an incline or perform flat sprints.

## **Running Mixed Intervals (RMI)**

Although complex, this workout spans Zones 1 to 5, providing significant cardiovascular benefits. Achieving discomfort is expected, but avoid excessive pain.

## **Running Anaerobic Intervals (RAn)**

These workouts enhance aerobic capacity and running

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economy, best utilized in early training cycles, laying the groundwork for improved performance in race-specific efforts.

### **Running Short Intervals (RSI)**

Performed on flat terrain, these intervals can substitute for hill repeats and allow for maximum effort without gradient constraints.

### **Running Speed Play (RSP)**

This workout includes smaller doses of Zone 4 efforts to provide moderate aerobic stimulation, encouraging aerobic development with controlled intensity.

### **Running Taper (RTa)**

Designed for race weeks, this workout ensures sufficient intensity to stay sharp without causing fatigue. Monitoring intensity through perceived effort, power, or pace is essential.

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# Best Quotes from 80/20 Triathlon by Matt Fitzgerald with Page Numbers

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## Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 18-29

1. The last of the three hypothetical scenarios we offered concerns another important training variable: intensity, or how hard you swim, bike, and run relative to your personal limits.
2. Every triathlete we coach is placed on an 80/20 program, and every athlete who follows the program we provide gets positive results.
3. Now it's your turn. The purpose of this book is to give every triathlete the opportunity to benefit from 80/20 training as Billy and the other athletes we've coached have already done.
4. Learning and practicing 80/20 training will transform your triathlon experience, making your workouts more comfortable and enjoyable, enhancing your postworkout recovery, reducing your injury risk, accelerating your

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fitness development, and taking your performance in races to a whole new level.

## **Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 30-56**

1. Training slowly so as to race fast remains as counterintuitive for many recreational triathletes today as it was for Zátopek seventy years ago.
2. Bad habits are hard to break. The moderate-intensity rut is no exception.
3. The week of slow is a gateway to 80/20 training.
4. Intensity blindness...requires that you use objective measures, such as heart rate, to monitor and control your intensity in workouts.

## **Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 57-80**

1. The optimal training recipe for endurance fitness combines large amounts of low-intensity work with relatively small amounts of work at moderate and high intensities.
2. If you want to gain the greatest amount of fitness from the time you invest in training, you would be as remiss to leave

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high intensity out of your training recipe as you would to neglect low or moderate intensity.

3. Think of it as the Goldilocks Zone: neither too little nor too much, but just right to actualize 100 percent of that intensity's potential to enhance endurance fitness.

4. A glance at the science shows why all three intensity ranges are essential ingredients in the recipe for endurance fitness.

5. As little as [three high-intensity interval training] sessions per week, involving "d10 min of intense e time commitment of "d30 min per session, to improve aerobic capacity.

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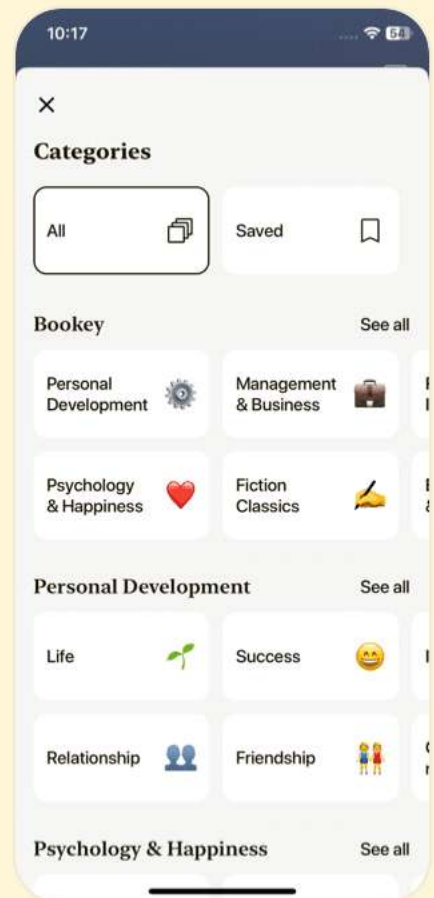
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## Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 81-102

- 1.If you have one weakness (not donut-related), it's probably swimming.
- 2.The surest way to improve your swimming is—you guessed it—to swim the 80/20 way, doing 80 percent of your pool (and open-water) training at low intensity and the remaining 20 percent at moderate to high intensity.
- 3.Training in this zone confers numerous benefits, including increased fat-burning capacity and a more fatigue-resistant brain.
- 4.Zone X is the moderate-intensity trap that most triathletes fall into, and avoiding it is one of the key objectives of 80/20 training.
- 5.It's better to perform a set of five Zone 3 intervals in the middle of the zone than to do the first four at the top of the zone and the last at the bottom due to fatigue.
- 6.The basic building blocks of any training system, including the 80/20 system, are individual workouts.

## Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 103-120

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1. Spending hours and hours in the saddle is not sufficient to maximize cycling fitness...
2. Every workout you do is like a single brush stroke on a large canvas.
3. If you plan on spending most of the winter months on an indoor trainer... that is the best environment in which to perform your LTHR testing.
4. A higher cadence delays fatigue, using muscle fibers that are designed for sustained use.

## **Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 121-142**

1. The greatest barrier to better running is incorrect distribution of intensity.
2. Running the 80/20 way will correct this problem.
3. Our species is biologically better suited to distance running than is any other mammal.
4. You may find that, over time, your cycling LTHR increases and your running LTHR does not, so that the two eventually converge.
5. The effects of working out at a particular intensity are

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determined not by how much distance you cover at that intensity, but by how much time you spend there.

6. Becoming a more efficient runner is a big part of becoming a more proficient runner.

7. Besides, the fool's errand of trying to maintain a certain pace on a long hill can be avoided with a known heart rate for a desired intensity.

8. The 80/20 Rule itself is based on time, not distance.

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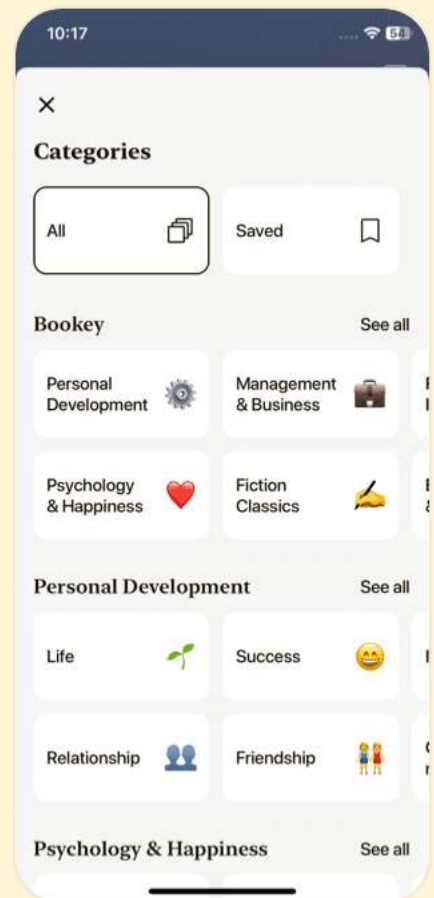
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## Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 143-172

1. Strength training (weightlifting and other forms of moving against resistance) increases the force-producing capacity of the muscles and is proven to improve running efficiency and reduce the risk of some of the overuse injuries that are common in triathletes.
2. Mobility is the ability of the shoulders, hips, and other major joints to move efficiently through a full range of motion.
3. Flexibility refers to a joint's passive range of motion (ROM).
4. But there's the rub. Many triathletes find it hard enough to fit all of the swimming, cycling, and running they wish to do into their schedule and feel there just aren't enough hours in the day to add anything else, benefits notwithstanding.
5. You can get the lion's share of the benefits that ancillary training offers through a pragmatic approach that is simple

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and time-efficient.

6. It has concentrated a lot more on my core, focused on my hips and glutes (which get neglected by most traditional bodybuilding exercises other than squats), made my ankles and knees more stable, and improved my strength without bulking me up.
7. The twelve stretches described in this section may be performed all together as a stand-alone flexibility routine, but there are a couple of reasons you might choose to do otherwise.
8. It's okay to do a little here, a little there, throughout the day until you've met this quota, though the ideal time to stretch is immediately after a swim, ride, or run, when the muscles are warm and loosened.

## **Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 173-207**

1. The key to a successful racing cycle is training very lightly between events.
2. You should set aside every third or fourth week for recovery even during periods when you're not racing.

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- 3.The first week of a new training cycle is responsible for getting you started in the right direction.
- 4.Don't let perfect be the enemy of good when you sit down to create a training plan for yourself.
- 5.You can get equally good results from a variety of plans, provided the differences aren't drastic.
- 6.The single most challenging workout of the peak step cycle is a weekly bike-run brick workout.

## **Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 208-210**

- 1.You may combine any two swim workouts into a single session to reduce the number of days with two workouts.
- 2.If a bike and run are scheduled on the same day, start with the workout containing the most intensity.
- 3.Recovery weeks can be identified by a sharp decrease in volume from the previous week.
- 4.Feel free to move the workouts around in these plans to better accommodate your personal schedule.

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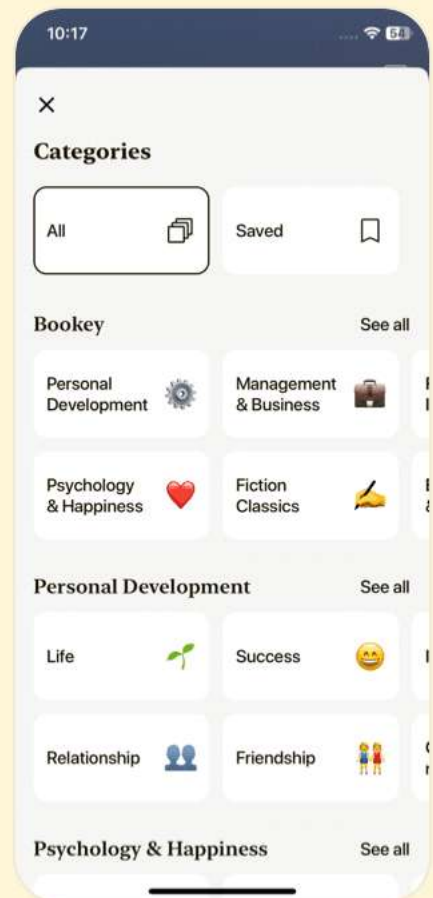
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## Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 211-214

- 1.No other established triathlon distance provides a better return on an athlete's investment than the sprint.
- 2.Sprints are typically performed at the upper level of Zone 3.
- 3.Racing successfully at the sprint distance requires balanced and specific preparation, and this is precisely what our 80/20 sprint training plans supply.
- 4.This plan is intended for individuals with a goal of finishing their first sprint event.
- 5.You should be comfortably able to swim and run for 45 minutes and cycle for 60 minutes and complete at least 4 total hours of aerobic exercise over seven days.

## Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 215-218

- 1.Olympic triathlon training provides (and requires) outstanding balance between raw speed and endurance.
- 2.Individuals in Olympic shape can easily step down and

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race a sprint, and with little additional training can comfortably complete a half Ironman.

3. Although it is similar to sprint training in structure, Olympic training can be grueling.

4. Falling into the moderate-intensity rut is especially damaging for triathletes in training for the Olympic distance.

5. Our 80/20 Olympic triathlon training plans have been carefully designed to keep you from going over the edge.

## **Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 219-224**

1. A half Ironman requires a full plan and a full barrel of molasses.

2. The 80/20 principles infused in our plans will provide the structure you need for success at this challenging distance.

3. Moving up to the half Ironman from shorter distances often proves to be transformative for the athlete who does so, but this transformation does not come without sacrifice and risk.

4. These sessions are good opportunities to practice pacing

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and nutrition, and to test out race equipment so that these things are familiar on race day.

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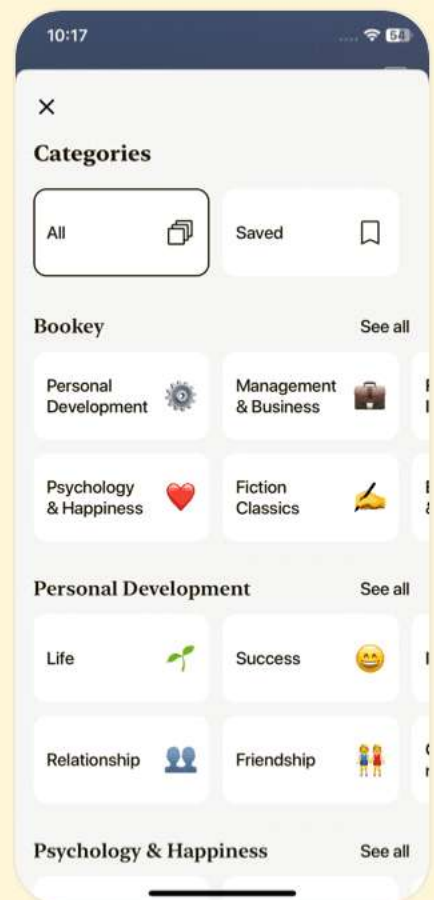
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## Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 225-229

- 1.The allure of Ironman is undeniable.
- 2.Completing an Ironman is almost universally considered a watershed moment that is fondly remembered by those who accept the challenge.
- 3.The best-prepared Ironman participants complete the event with a smile on their face.
- 4.Our plans will have you looking great in your finish line photo, delivering the maximal return on your valuable training time.
- 5.Ironman was built on legends, but if you are looking to finish an Ironman in agony, staggering over the finish line and being dragged to the med tent, then 80/20 training is not for you.

## Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 232-258

- 1.Optimal pacing, then, can be defined as a distribution of effort across an entire race that results in the shortest possible completion time for a particular individual on a given day.

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- 2.The goal is to cover the entire race distance in the least amount of time possible.
- 3.Your performance in this first half Ironman or Ironman run leg will set a baseline for future goal-setting.
- 4.Engaging in this exercise one time in isolation won't make you a master of the art of pacing by feel, but as a routine practice, it will greatly advance your pacing skill.
- 5.Few things aid progress toward the goal of a perfectly paced triathlon more than a poorly paced triathlon.

## **Chapter 15 | Quotes From Pages 259-264**

- 1.Recovery after hard training is often accelerated with light activity, and fortunately for triathletes, swimming is one of the best exercise modalities for active recovery.
- 2.First and foremost, they are essential to maintaining an optimal 80/20 intensity balance in swim training.
- 3.The 'big brother' of the Swim Cruise Interval, the Swim Tempo workout removes the rest breaks between Zone 3 efforts to challenge your ability to sustain this intensity

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over relatively long distances.

4.By requiring you to swim a large number of efforts at very high intensity, the Swim Short Interval workout will test your ability to maintain form at high speed through mounting fatigue.

5.The Swim Speed Play workout is an effective tool for improving critical velocity.

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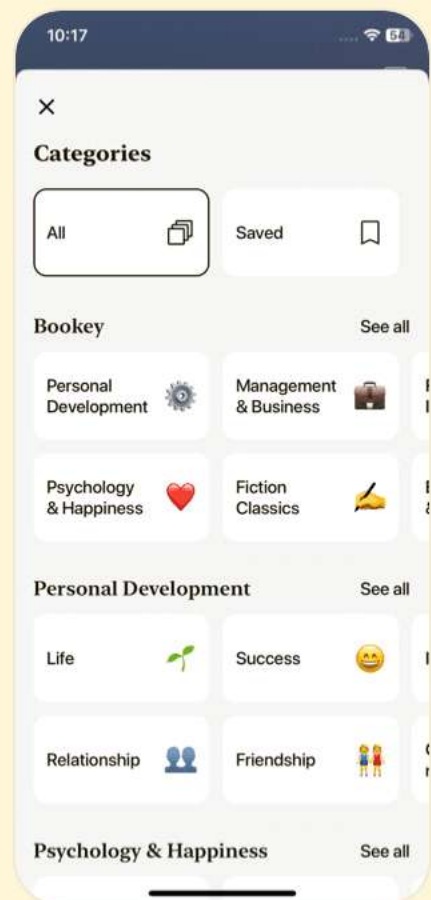
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## Chapter 16 | Quotes From Pages 265-273

1. Discipline and humility are demanded by the Cycling Foundation ride.
2. When done with fresh legs, there may be a strong temptation to drift above Zone 2.
3. Muscular endurance is the ability to apply force over an extended period of time, and it is arguably the most important ability you can develop as a triathlete.
4. When executed properly, the Cycling Anaerobic Interval ride is the most effective way to increase your aerobic capacity, or VO<sub>2</sub>max.

## Chapter 17 | Quotes From Pages 274-280

1. Consider Zone 2, the 'vegetables' of your training diet. Whether you hate or love the intensity, a healthy dose nourishes long-term rewards.
2. Remember, pain is temporary, but your official run split on the Internet is forever!
3. Regular practice of the Running Anaerobic Intervals workout has the potential to transform your running

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through increased aerobic capacity and improved running economy.

4.If you like to run hard, this workout is an excellent opportunity to do so, but avoid running so hard that you cannot complete all of the prescribed hill repeats at the same output.

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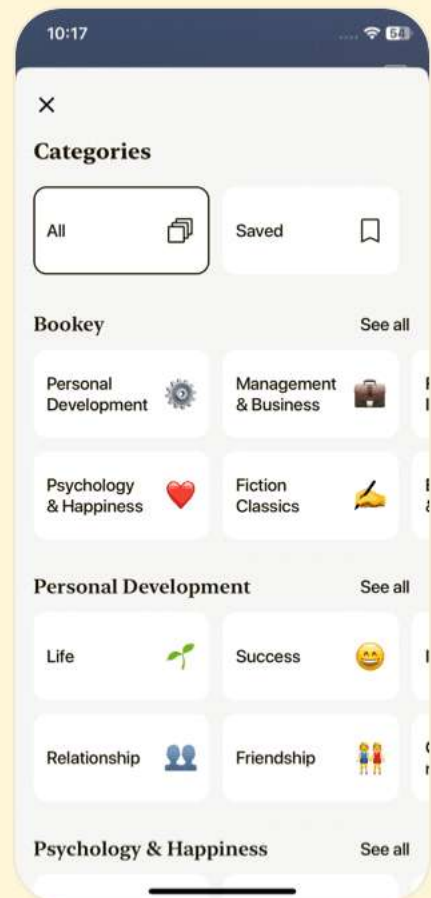
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# 80/20 Triathlon Questions

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## Chapter 1 | 1 The Most Effective Way to Train| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the essence of effective training for a triathlon?**

Answer:The essence of effective training for a triathlon lies in specificity, volume, and intensity.

Training must be specific to the triathlon's demands, optimized in volume to avoid undertraining or overtraining, and appropriately intense to maximize performance without leading to fatigue.

### 2.Question

**Why is the 80/20 Rule significant in triathlon training?**

Answer:The 80/20 Rule is significant because it shows that elite endurance athletes train approximately 80% of the time at low intensity and only 20% at moderate to high intensities. This balance allows them to perform better than those who overdo moderate intensity, preventing chronic fatigue.

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### 3.Question

**How can triathletes avoid the moderate-intensity rut?**

Answer: Triathletes can avoid the moderate-intensity rut by recognizing the difference between low and moderate intensity, commonly understood as training just below the ventilatory threshold. They should focus on dedicating the majority of their training to low intensity to enhance recovery and improve performance.

### 4.Question

**What changes did Billy Hafferty experience after adopting the 80/20 training plan?**

Answer: After adopting the 80/20 training plan, Billy Hafferty experienced a significant improvement in his triathlon performance, achieving a personal-best time and qualifying for the Ironman World Championship. His training became more structured with designated purposes for each workout, effectively breaking out of his previous moderation bias.

### 5.Question

**What are the benefits of following the 80/20 training**

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## **method?**

Answer: Following the 80/20 training method can lead to numerous benefits, including improved workout comfort and enjoyment, better post-workout recovery, reduced injury risk, accelerated fitness development, and enhanced race performance. It empowers athletes to train more efficiently and effectively.

## **6.Question**

### **How can the 80/20 method transform a triathlete's experience?**

Answer: The 80/20 method can transform a triathlete's experience by making workouts less taxing, promoting faster recovery, and boosting overall fitness and race readiness. This balanced approach can make training feel more sustainable and enjoyable while yielding better results.

## **7.Question**

### **What common barriers might triathletes face when adopting the 80/20 approach?**

Answer: Common barriers include skepticism about training

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slower to run faster, lack of understanding of intensity levels, and difficulty in adjusting to a structured training program. Many triathletes may also not recognize their habitual intensity levels and how they affect performance.

### 8.Question

**What foundational science supports the effectiveness of the 80/20 training approach?**

Answer: The foundational science supporting the 80/20 approach includes research by exercise physiologist Stephen Seiler, who analyzed the training regimens of elite athletes, revealing that their optimal performance was linked to this specific intensity distribution. This evidence suggests that both elite and recreational athletes could benefit from similar training strategies.

### 9.Question

**What is the ultimate goal of the training principles outlined in '80/20 Triathlon'?**

Answer: The ultimate goal of the training principles outlined in '80/20 Triathlon' is to equip triathletes of all levels with

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effective strategies to enhance their training, overcome barriers, and achieve personal breakthroughs in performance.

### 10.Question

**What should readers expect as they progress through the book?**

Answer:Readers can expect a comprehensive guide that addresses barriers to optimal training, provides scientific backing for the 80/20 methodology, and offers practical advice on applying these principles to swimming, cycling, and running, culminating in custom training plans tailored to individual needs.

## Chapter 2 | 2 Going Slower to Get Faster| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What was the key finding of Iñigo Mujika's case study on Ainhua Murúa's training?**

Answer:Mujika found that Ainhua Murúa performed 83% of her training below her lactate threshold, exemplifying the 80/20 rule in training intensity, which contributed to her success as an

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Olympic triathlete.

## 2.Question

**Why do most recreational triathletes struggle to follow the 80/20 training method?**

Answer:They often fall into the moderate-intensity rut, spending less than 70% of their training efforts below the ventilatory threshold, leading to minimal performance improvement.

## 3.Question

**What historical factors contributed to the evolution of the 80/20 training method among elite triathletes?**

Answer:Competition and the necessity for effective preparation led elite athletes to adopt the 80/20 training balance as they recognized its efficacy in achieving better race results.

## 4.Question

**What are some barriers that keep recreational triathletes from effectively implementing 80/20 training?**

Answer:Common barriers include smaller low-intensity ranges, lower training volumes, bad coaching, ego issues,

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misconceptions about training intensity, and habitual inertia.

### 5.Question

**How can recreational triathletes recalibrate their training approach effectively?**

Answer:By embracing a 'week of slow' where they gradually slow down their workouts, they can learn to comfortably maintain low-intensity efforts and break the cycle of training too hard.

### 6.Question

**What did Mark Allen's transition to a mostly low-intensity training method achieve for his triathlon career?**

Answer:This shift allowed Allen to become the best triathlete in the world during his career, demonstrating the effectiveness of 80/20 training.

### 7.Question

**How can triathletes overcome their ego in training?**

Answer:Triathletes can effectively manage their ego by focusing on their personal training goals and understanding that training at lower intensities is vital for improvement.

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## 8.Question

**What is intensity blindness, and how does it affect recreational triathletes?**

Answer: Intensity blindness is the misconception that low-intensity workouts feel too easy; it leads them to unknowingly train at moderate or high intensities instead of adhering to the targeted low-intensity training.

## 9.Question

**What is the importance of monitoring heart rate in training?**

Answer: Using heart rate data helps triathletes accurately assess their training intensities, ensuring they spend the appropriate amount of time below the ventilatory threshold, critical for effective 80/20 training.

## 10.Question

**Why is it essential to embrace comfort in low-intensity training?**

Answer: Accepting a slower pace allows athletes to recover better, reduce fatigue, and ultimately enhance performance in higher-intensity efforts when trained correctly.

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## Chapter 3 | 3 The Science of 80/20 Training| Q&A

### 1.Question

**Why is an 80/20 intensity balance important in triathlon training?**

Answer:The 80/20 intensity balance ensures that low-intensity training, which comprises 80% of total training time, optimally develops cardiovascular fitness and efficiency, while the remaining 20% allows for higher intensity work critical for speed and endurance adaptations.

### 2.Question

**How does the body adapt physiologically to low-intensity training?**

Answer:Low-intensity training enhances aerobic capacity by strengthening the heart, increasing blood volume and red blood cell count, improving mitochondrial production, and enhancing fat utilization as fuel, which are crucial for endurance performance.

### 3.Question

**What role does moderate intensity play in endurance**

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**training?**

Answer: Moderate intensity training overlaps with race speeds, allowing athletes to prepare for the paces they aim to sustain during events, while also improving overall metabolic and biomechanical efficiency.

#### **4.Question**

**Can high-intensity workouts be entirely excluded from a triathlon training program?**

Answer: No, high-intensity workouts are essential for maximizing aerobic capacity and should be included, although they represent a smaller proportion of the training volume due to their high stress on the body.

#### **5.Question**

**How did historical trends in athlete training reflect the effectiveness of the 80/20 rule?**

Answer: Historical data shows elite athletes shifted towards spending a greater percentage of their training time at low intensities while reducing high-intensity workouts, resulting in measurable improvements in their endurance performance.

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## 6.Question

**What does research say about the optimal balance of training intensities for endurance athletes?**

Answer: Research indicates that an optimal training program combines large amounts of low-intensity work with smaller amounts of moderate and high-intensity training, typically around 75-80% low intensity to achieve the best performance outcomes.

## 7.Question

**What can be inferred from interventional studies comparing different training intensity distributions?**

Answer: Interventional studies show that athletes training with an 80/20 distribution tend to achieve greater performance improvements than those following more traditional high-volume approaches, emphasizing the benefits of the 80/20 system.

## 8.Question

**Why is it important to include low-intensity workouts in training?**

Answer: Low-intensity workouts are essential for building a

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strong aerobic base, enhancing fat utilization, and providing a foundation for developing endurance without the fatigue associated with high-intensity efforts.

### 9.Question

**How does high-intensity training differ from low- and moderate-intensity training in terms of recovery?**

Answer:High-intensity training is more stressful and requires longer recovery times compared to low-intensity exercise, which allows for quicker recovery and can be done more frequently without adverse effects.

### 10.Question

**What practical tips can athletes derive from the 80/20 training methodology?**

Answer:Athletes should focus on incorporating low-intensity sessions for the bulk of their training, strategically add moderate intensity for race pacing practice, and limit high-intensity workouts to ensure optimal recovery and performance adaptations.

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## Chapter 4 | 4 Swimming the 80/20 Way| Q&A

### 1.Question

**Why is swimming often considered a triathlete's weak point?**

Answer:Swimming is often perceived as a weakness for many triathletes because water can be intimidating, and mastering the technique takes time and practice. Many athletes come from running or cycling backgrounds, where improvement can be more straightforward, but swimming requires a unique skill set that many find uncomfortable.

### 2.Question

**How does the 80/20 training method improve swimming performance?**

Answer:The 80/20 training method enhances swimming performance by allocating 80% of swim training to low-intensity efforts and 20% to moderate to high intensity. This allows for improved aerobic capacity and fosters better swimming technique without overwhelming the athlete.

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### 3.Question

**What is the ventilatory threshold (VT), and why is it important for swimmers?**

Answer:The ventilatory threshold (VT) is the exercise intensity at which breathing starts to become labored.

Identifying your VT is crucial because it allows swimmers to gauge their training intensity, ensuring they train at the correct effort levels to maximize performance gains.

### 4.Question

**What role does lactate threshold (LT) play in swim training?**

Answer:Lactate threshold (LT) is the intensity level at which lactate begins to accumulate in the blood. Training at or near this intensity helps improve an athlete's speed and endurance, acting as a key predictor of race performance.

### 5.Question

**How can swimmers calculate their lactate threshold swim pace (LTSP)?**

Answer:Swimmers can determine their LTSP by performing a time trial, swimming 400 yards to get their time, followed

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by a 200-yard time trial, and then using these times in a formula that calculates their critical velocity (CV), which corresponds to their LTSP.

### 6.Question

**Why is it essential to avoid spending too much time in Zone X during training?**

Answer:Zone X represents a moderate-intensity trap that can feel deceptively comfortable but does not provide significant fitness improvements. Training excessively in this zone can lead to fatigue, adversely affecting subsequent workouts.

### 7.Question

**What strategies can athletes use to establish their swim intensity zones?**

Answer:Athletes can establish swim intensity zones by first determining their lactate threshold swim pace (LTSP) and then using this information to create personalized intensity zones as percentages of their LTSP, recalculating them regularly as fitness improves.

### 8.Question

**What are some specific swim drills recommended for**

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## **improving technique?**

Answer: Drills like the Catch-Up Drill, High Elbow Swim, Swim Golf, and Kick Drills are recommended to improve swim technique by reducing drag and increasing propulsive efficiency, which are critical for faster swim times.

## **9.Question**

### **How often should swimmers reassess their training zones and why?**

Answer: Swimmers should reassess their training zones every three to six weeks during periods of progressive training or whenever they feel they are 'outgrowing' their current zones to ensure optimal training adjustments.

## **10.Question**

### **Why is proper pacing important in high-intensity swim workouts?**

Answer: Proper pacing in high-intensity workouts ensures athletes can maintain performance throughout the entire session. It's crucial to avoid going too fast initially and risking burnout, which would prevent completing the

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necessary training volume effectively.

## **Chapter 5 | 5 Cycling the 80/20 Way| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**Why is biking considered the most important discipline in triathlon?**

Answer:Cycling is crucial in triathlon because it typically accounts for a significant portion of the race time, often more than swimming and running combined. A strong cycling performance can enhance overall race results and even improve running capabilities by allowing athletes to conserve energy for the run segment.

### **2.Question**

**How does applying the 80/20 rule to cycling benefit triathletes?**

Answer:Utilizing the 80/20 rule in cycling training ensures that athletes spend 80% of their time in lower-intensity workouts and only 20% in higher-intensity efforts. This approach promotes greater fitness gains, reduces the risk of

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burnout or injury, and maintains enjoyment in riding.

### 3.Question

**What is the purpose of lactate threshold testing in cycling?**

Answer:Lactate threshold testing helps determine the intensity zones at which training should occur to maximize fitness gains. It identifies the point at which lactate begins to accumulate in the blood, allowing cyclists to train more effectively by working in the right intensity zones.

### 4.Question

**How can heart rate and power be used in cycling training?**

Answer:Heart rate and power are metrics used to gauge exercise intensity. Heart rate monitoring helps cyclists stay within their target zones, while power measurement provides a direct and often more reliable reflection of effort, allowing for precise intensity control in training.

### 5.Question

**What factors may affect heart rate during cycling?**

Answer:Heart rate can be influenced by various factors,

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including ambient temperature, hydration levels, stress, sleep quality, time of day, diet, and equipment used. This variability emphasizes the need for athletes to understand their heart rate responses under different conditions.

## 6.Question

**How can perceived effort be utilized in cycling training?**

Answer:The Rating of Perceived Effort (RPE) scale allows athletes to judge their exercise intensity without devices.

This subjective measure requires calibration against objective metrics to be effective, and its accurate application can enhance awareness of workout effort and improve training outcomes.

## 7.Question

**What should triathletes focus on during their cycling workouts?**

Answer:Triathletes should maintain a big-picture perspective when training, letting each workout serve its purpose while building overall fitness. Consistency in executing the planned workouts correctly leads to significant improvements over

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time.

### 8.Question

**What is the significance of cadence in cycling?**

Answer:Cadence, or the speed of pedaling, is crucial as a higher cadence can delay fatigue and promote the use of muscle fibers designed for endurance. It is generally recommended to aim for around 90 revolutions per minute to preserve energy and improve performance.

### 9.Question

**How can triathletes improve their cycling performance?**

Answer:Improvement can be achieved by consistently training in defined intensity zones, conducting regular lactate threshold and power tests, focusing on optimal cadence, and ensuring proper recovery to enhance fitness and efficiency in cycling.

### 10.Question

**What role does the 80/20 cycling workouts format play for triathletes?**

Answer:The 80/20 cycling workouts are structured to offer a variety of intensities and durations, each serving a specific

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purpose to develop different aspects of cycling fitness. Following this structured approach helps athletes build comprehensive cycling skills for better race performance.

## **Chapter 6 | 6 Running the 80/20 Way| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What is the main reason running can be challenging for many athletes?**

Answer:Running imposes more stress on the body and carries more risk of injury compared to swimming or cycling.

### **2.Question**

**How can understanding lactate threshold heart rate (LTHR) help improve running performance?**

Answer:By identifying your LTHR, you can accurately calculate your personal training intensity zones, allowing for a more effective training approach.

### **3.Question**

**Why is it important to conduct separate LTHR tests for running and cycling?**

Answer:Running and cycling LTHR are usually different;

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often the running LTHR is several beats per minute higher, which emphasizes the need for tailored intensity assessments.

#### 4.Question

**What is the significance of maintaining a specific heart rate during running?**

Answer: Maintaining a heart rate close to your established LTHR allows you to train effectively in your desired intensity zones, optimizing performance and endurance.

#### 5.Question

**How does using a power meter in running enhance training accuracy?**

Answer: A power meter measures output in watts, providing real-time data unaffected by external factors like weather, enabling precise intensity monitoring during runs.

#### 6.Question

**What are some advantages of performing time-based workouts instead of distance-based workouts?**

Answer: Time-based workouts reduce the temptation to push too hard to complete a distance, ensure adherence to training plans, allow for precise 80/20 training ratios, and ensure

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equitably effective intensity doses across athletes.

### 7.Question

**What running drills are suggested to enhance efficiency in running form?**

Answer:Drills such as cadence counting, hands-on-head exercise, high knees, and skipping are recommended to address common form flaws and improve overall running effectiveness.

### 8.Question

**How can athletes utilize the online 80/20 Zone Calculator?**

Answer:The online calculator simplifies the process of determining running pace and heart rate training zones, presenting clear metrics for effective training plans.

### 9.Question

**What is the relationship between running intensity and perceived effort (RPE) during challenging runs?**

Answer:In tough conditions (e.g., hills, cold mornings), perceived effort can guide maintaining the right intensity when pace or heart rate metrics are compromised.

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## 10.Question

**Why is it unnecessary to complete the full distance of an Ironman triathlon in training?**

Answer: Completing the entire distance in one workout isn't necessary as infrequent, high-volume workouts combined with time-based training can effectively prepare an athlete for race day.

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## Chapter 7 | 7 Strength, Flexibility, and Mobility Training| Q&A

### 1.Question

**Why is strength training important for triathletes?**

Answer:Strength training increases the force-producing capacity of muscles, improves running efficiency, and reduces the risk of common overuse injuries in triathletes.

### 2.Question

**How does mobility training benefit triathletes?**

Answer:Mobility training ensures that major joints can move efficiently through a full range of motion, leading to more efficient swimming, cycling, and running.

### 3.Question

**What is the difference between flexibility and mobility in the context of training?**

Answer:Flexibility refers to a joint's passive range of motion, while mobility is about the ability to actively move through that range efficiently.

### 4.Question

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## **Can triathletes benefit from strength and flexibility training without significant time commitments?**

Answer: Yes, a pragmatic and flexible approach to strength, flexibility, and mobility training can yield benefits without requiring extensive time commitments, making it achievable even for busy athletes.

### **5.Question**

## **What are some recommended types of strength and flexibility exercises for recreational triathletes?**

Answer: Recreational triathletes can engage in at-home strength workouts using minimal equipment like a stability ball, plus various mobility and flexibility exercises that target specific problem areas to enhance performance.

### **6.Question**

## **Why do some triathletes neglect strength and flexibility training?**

Answer: Many triathletes find it challenging to fit ancillary training into their schedules, prioritizing swimming, cycling, and running over these additional training components.

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## 7.Question

**What are the key components of an effective at-home strength workout for triathletes?**

Answer:An effective at-home strength workout should involve a ten-movement full-body routine that can be done in comfort, focused on functional movements with minimal equipment.

## 8.Question

**Is it necessary for recreational triathletes to follow complex strength training programs?**

Answer:No, recreational triathletes can benefit significantly from simpler strength training programs designed for efficiency and effectiveness rather than complex routines followed by professional athletes.

## 9.Question

**How can a triathlete integrate mobility exercises into their training?**

Answer:Mobility exercises can be incorporated as part of warm-ups for swims, bike rides, and runs, or they can be alternated with strength training movements for greater

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efficiency.

### 10.Question

**What long-term benefits have triathletes experienced from adopting updated strength training methods?**

Answer:Triathletes like Bob Kusenberger have reported improved core focus, stability in ankles and knees, enhanced glute and hip strength, and overall strength gains without increasing body weight, all contributing to better performance.

## Chapter 8 | 8 Getting Started with 80/20 Training| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the core philosophy behind 80/20 triathlon training?**

Answer:The core philosophy of 80/20 triathlon training is to balance the intensity of workouts such that 80% of the training is done at low intensity and 20% at moderate to high intensity. This approach helps athletes avoid burnout and injuries while ensuring progressive fitness improvements.

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## 2.Question

**Why is it important to create a well-designed training plan?**

Answer:A well-designed training plan is crucial because it provides structure, helps track progress, and aligns training with peak performance goals for competitions. Athletes are likely to see greater fitness and performance improvements compared to arbitrary training.

## 3.Question

**How should recovery weeks be incorporated into a training cycle?**

Answer:Recovery weeks should be scheduled every third or fourth week during a training cycle. They involve reducing the training load by 30%-40% to allow the body to recuperate and prepare for increasing workloads in subsequent weeks.

## 4.Question

**What is a training cycle, and how long should it typically last?**

Answer:A training cycle is a structured period of progressive

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training typically lasting between 12 to 24 weeks. It begins when you start building your fitness for a competition and ends with a key race or a series of races.

### 5.Question

**What factors influence the length of a training cycle?**

Answer:The length of a training cycle depends on several factors, including the athlete's current fitness level, the distance of the target race, and the number of races planned. Longer races usually necessitate longer training cycles.

### 6.Question

**What are the steps for creating a custom 80/20 triathlon training plan?**

Answer:The steps include: 1. Define your training cycle, 2. Schedule recovery weeks, 3. Create a default weekly workout schedule, 4. Plan your peak training step cycle, 5. Plan your first training week, and 6. Fill in the rest of your schedule.

### 7.Question

**How can an athlete effectively plan their peak training step cycle?**

Answer:An athlete should plan their peak training step cycle

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as the heaviest two to three weeks of training before tapering. This period should focus on challenging workouts that simulate upcoming race conditions and prepare the body for peak performance.

### 8.Question

**Why is it emphasized to include a variety of workouts in each discipline?**

Answer:Including a variety of workouts in each discipline (swimming, biking, running) helps improve overall fitness and prevent monotony. It also allows for a balanced approach to build strength, endurance, and specific race skills.

### 9.Question

**What common mistake should athletes avoid when creating a training plan?**

Answer:One common mistake to avoid is striving for perfection in training plans. It's essential to understand that there's no perfect plan, and focusing on creating a good-enough plan, while being adaptable based on responses to training, is more beneficial.

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## 10.Question

**How can an athlete gauge the effectiveness of their training distribution?**

Answer:Athletes can gauge the effectiveness of their training distribution by calculating the percentage of time spent in low, moderate, and high-intensity zones. This should aim for approximately 80% low intensity and 20% moderate to high intensity.

## 11.Question

**What should an athlete keep in mind during their first training week of a new cycle?**

Answer:During the first week of a new training cycle, athletes should ensure that the workouts are slightly more challenging than what they were doing prior. They should also be careful with intensity levels, particularly in the context of base training.

## Chapter 9 | 9 Introduction to 80/20 Training Plans| Q&A

### 1.Question

**How should I prioritize my workouts on days with both**

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## **swimming and running?**

Answer: On days with both a bike and run scheduled, prioritize the one that has the most intensity first. If they have similar intensity, start with the discipline in which you are weakest.

## **2.Question**

### **Can I combine workouts if I find the plan too demanding?**

Answer: Yes, you can combine any two swim workouts into a single session to ease the training load, ensuring you still follow the overall intensity guidelines.

## **3.Question**

### **What adjustments can I make to the training schedule if I need to?**

Answer: Feel free to move workouts around in the plans to fit your personal schedule, while still adhering to the guidelines for workout distribution laid out in Chapter 8.

## **4.Question**

### **Why is it suggested to do a swim workout in open water before race day?**

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Answer: Performing a swim workout in open water, or with a wetsuit if applicable, helps acclimate you to the conditions of your event, enhancing both comfort and performance.

### 5.Question

**What should I look for to identify recovery weeks in my training plan?**

Answer: Recovery weeks can be identified by a sharp decrease in volume from the previous week. This is crucial for allowing your body to rest and recover effectively.

### 6.Question

**What should I keep in mind regarding swim workouts and intensity distribution?**

Answer: Swim workouts are based on distance, not time, so the total weekly training duration provided is an estimate. Pay close attention to the distribution of low and moderate/high intensity as indicated in the training plans.

### 7.Question

**Is it okay to schedule swim workouts on a rest day?**

Answer: Yes, you are encouraged to move any swim workouts to Monday, traditionally a rest day, if it better fits

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your schedule.

### 8.Question

**How can I ensure my training is effective leading up to the race?**

Answer: Make sure to follow the distribution of workouts closely, especially regarding intensity, and maintain a balance between full and reduced-volume weeks for optimal performance.

### 9.Question

**What indicates a shift from one training week to another in the schedule?**

Answer: The shaded rows in the training schedules help distinguish one week from another, though they do not indicate recovery weeks.

### 10.Question

**What is the significance of following the training zone information in Chapters 4 to 6?**

Answer: The training zones outlined in Chapters 4 to 6 provide critical information to help you train effectively, ensuring that your workouts align with your performance

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goals.

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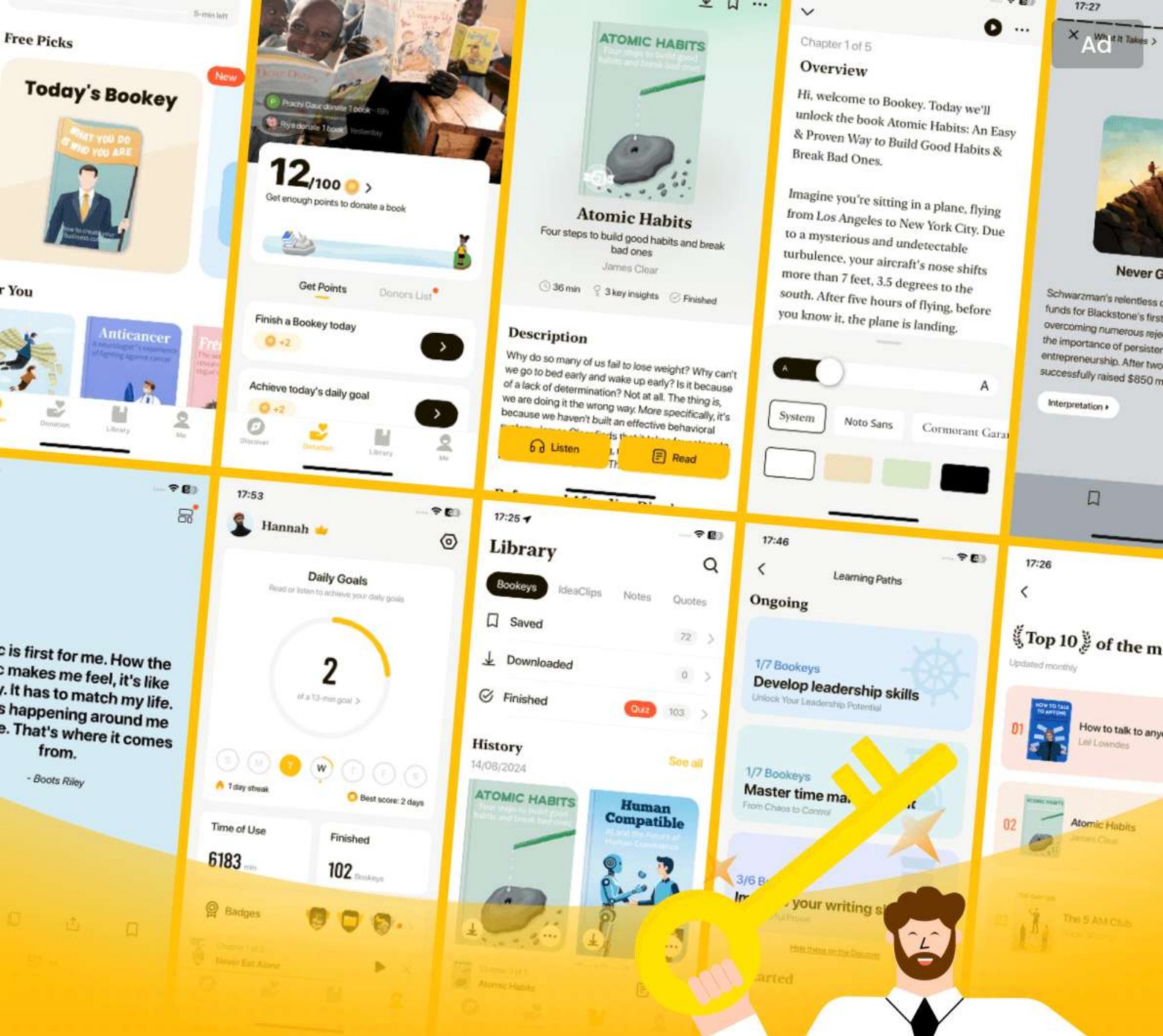


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## **Chapter 10 | 10 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Sprint Distance| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What is the primary benefit of sprint distance triathlons compared to longer distances?**

Answer:Sprint distance triathlons provide a better return on investment due to their shorter recovery times, allowing athletes to race frequently without the extensive training burden associated with longer events.

### **2.Question**

**How often can an athlete compete in sprint triathlons compared to Ironman events?**

Answer:Athletes can race ten or more local sprint triathlons for the cost of a single Ironman, making it more financially accessible and practical to race often.

### **3.Question**

**Why are sprint triathlons particularly suitable for older and injury-prone athletes?**

Answer:Sprint triathlons are less taxing on the body due to

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their shorter distances, making them ideal for older and injury-prone triathletes who struggle with the rigors of longer events.

#### 4.Question

**What is the significance of the 80/20 approach in sprint training plans?**

Answer:The 80/20 approach ensures that training is balanced and specific, allowing athletes to optimize their performance through targeted preparation for sprint events.

#### 5.Question

**What are the different levels of training plans available for sprint distance triathlons?**

Answer:There are four sprint training plans: Level 0 (finishing first sprint), Level 1 (low-volume training for all levels), Level 2 (specific time goals for experienced athletes), and Level 3 (for serious competitors aiming for top age group placement).

#### 6.Question

**How does the training volume progress in the Level 1 sprint training plan?**

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Answer: In Level 1, training volume starts at approximately 6 hours in Week 1 and peaks at about 8.5 hours in Week 13.

### 7.Question

**What baseline fitness is required before starting the Level 0 sprint training plan?**

Answer: Athletes should be able to swim and run for 30 minutes, cycle for 45 minutes, and complete at least 3 hours of aerobic exercise over 7 days before starting the Level 0 plan.

### 8.Question

**What type of athlete should consider the Level 3 training plan?**

Answer: Serious triathletes who have a strong background in endurance racing and are already comfortable completing each discipline for an hour should consider the Level 3 training plan.

### 9.Question

**What does the taper phase involve in the context of sprint training plans?**

Answer: The taper phase, which lasts two weeks at the end of

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each plan, involves reducing training volume to allow the athlete to recover and peak for their event.

## **Chapter 11 | 11 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Olympic Distance| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What is the Olympic-distance triathlon and why is it considered perfect for endurance athletes?**

Answer:The Olympic-distance triathlon consists of a 1.5 km swim, 40 km bike, and 10 km run. It's considered perfect for all-around endurance athletes because it strikes an outstanding balance between speed and endurance, allowing athletes to compete successfully across various distances.

### **2.Question**

**What are the risks of improper training intensity for Olympic triathlon preparation?**

Answer:Improper training intensity, especially falling into a moderate-intensity rut, can be detrimental as Olympic training is grueling and demanding. If not properly balanced, high training volume combined with long intervals at high

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intensities can push athletes to their limits, risking burnout or injury.

### 3.Question

**What is the structure of the 80/20 Olympic triathlon training plans?**

Answer:The 80/20 Olympic triathlon training plans consist of four levels, ranging from 16 to 19 weeks. Each plan features a general phase lasting 12 to 14 weeks, transitioning into a specific phase followed by a two-week taper, ensuring a structured and progressive training timeline.

### 4.Question

**What baseline fitness is required to start the Level 0 training plan?**

Answer:To start the Level 0 training plan, individuals should be able to comfortably swim and run for 30 minutes each, cycle for 45 minutes, and complete at least 3 hours of aerobic exercise over seven days.

### 5.Question

**How does the weekly training volume change in the Level 1 Olympic training plan?**

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Answer: In the Level 1 Olympic training plan, the weekly training volume starts at approximately 6 hours in Week 1 and peaks at about 9.5 hours in Week 11, catering for a low-volume approach while still preparing for the Olympic distance.

## 6.Question

**Who should consider the Level 2 Olympic distance training plan?**

Answer: The Level 2 training plan is ideal for athletes aiming for a specific goal time in their next Olympic triathlon. It's designed for those who have previously completed at least one triathlon or possess a strong background in one of the three disciplines.

## 7.Question

**What conditions must athletes meet to enroll in the Level 3 Olympic communication plan?**

Answer: Athletes considering the Level 3 plan should be focused on finishing among the top performers in their age group. They should have competed in several endurance

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events and demonstrate the capability to swim and run for one hour, cycle for 90 minutes, and complete at least 6 hours of aerobic exercise weekly.

### 8.Question

**What happens during the taper phase in Olympic training plans?**

Answer:The taper phase lasts two weeks and serves to reduce training volume to allow the athlete to rest and recover while maintaining fitness levels, ensuring they are well-prepared and fresh for race day.

### 9.Question

**Why are high intervals and intense brick training necessary in Olympic triathlon preparation?**

Answer:High intervals and intense brick training are crucial for developing the necessary speed and endurance required to compete effectively in an Olympic triathlon, preparing the athlete to handle the demands of the race.

### 10.Question

**What advantages do Olympic distance trained athletes have for other race types?**

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Answer: Athletes who are trained for Olympic distances possess the versatility to transition easily to shorter formats like a sprint triathlon, or longer formats like a half Ironman, owing to their well-rounded fitness.

## **Chapter 12 | 12 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Half Ironman Distance| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**Why is the half Ironman such a popular distance for triathletes?**

Answer: The half Ironman is popular because it represents a significant challenge without being as overwhelming as the full Ironman. It attracts triathletes due to its combination of endurance, excitement, and the transformative journey that athletes experience while preparing for it. Many find that training for this distance opens up new possibilities for competing in various endurance events.

### **2.Question**

**What does it mean to transition from shorter triathlons to**

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## **a half Ironman?**

Answer: Transitioning from shorter triathlons, like sprint or Olympic distances, to a half Ironman can be transformative. It often involves a step up in training dedication and mental resilience, where athletes push their limits and discover new strengths. This shift requires commitment, patience, and the readiness to adapt to longer training sessions.

### **3.Question**

#### **How can athletes best prepare for the demands of a half Ironman?**

Answer: Athletes can best prepare by following a structured training plan that emphasizes the 80/20 principle, combining low-intensity workouts with more challenging training sessions. Incorporating brick sessions, where bike and run workouts are done back-to-back, is crucial to simulate race conditions, testing pacing, nutrition, and equipment ahead of race day.

### **4.Question**

#### **What is the significance of the general and specific**

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## **training phases in the half Ironman plan?**

Answer: The general phase focuses on enhancing speed, power, and endurance through varied intensity workouts. This sets a strong foundation before transitioning into the specific phase, which tailors training to the demands of the half Ironman. Despite the higher intensity ratios in the general phase, it prepares athletes physically and mentally for the prolonged effort required in the specific phase.

## **5.Question**

### **How should an athlete gauge their readiness to begin a Level 0 half Ironman training plan?**

Answer: An athlete should be comfortably capable of swimming and running for 45 minutes each and cycling for 60 minutes, complemented by a minimum of 3 hours of aerobic exercise over seven days. This ensures they possess a foundational fitness level to embark on a successful training journey.

## **6.Question**

### **What differentiates training levels in half Ironman plans?**

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Answer: The training levels vary based on an athlete's experience, fitness level, and goals. Level 0 is for first-time participants, while Levels 1, 2, and 3 cater to progressively more experienced athletes seeking to improve their performance. Each level has defined prerequisites concerning previous triathlon experience and minimum aerobic training to ensure safety and efficacy in training.

### 7.Question

**Why is the saying 'A half Ironman requires a full plan and a full barrel of molasses' relevant?**

Answer: This saying underscores the importance of comprehensive preparation and patience in training for a half Ironman. It highlights that achieving success in such a demanding event necessitates careful planning, dedication, and a steady, measured approach to training without rushing the process.

### 8.Question

**What is the role of nutrition and equipment testing in training for a half Ironman?**

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Answer: Nutrition and equipment testing during training—particularly in brick sessions—is crucial because it allows athletes to identify what works best for their bodies during long efforts. Familiarity with race-day nutrition strategies and equipment adjustments minimizes surprises and enhances confidence during the actual event.

### 9.Question

**What is the value of mental resilience in preparing for a half Ironman?**

Answer: Mental resilience is vital in half Ironman training because the physical demands can be intense, particularly in the later stages of the race. Developing mental toughness through consistent training and pushing past perceived limits prepares athletes to endure the psychological challenges they will face on race day.

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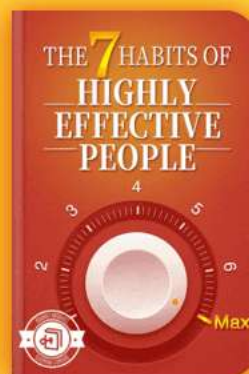
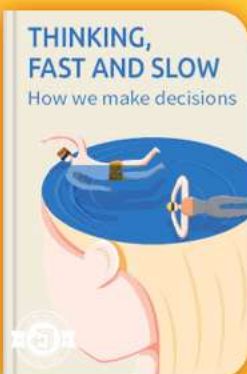


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## **Chapter 13 | 13 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Ironman Distance| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What is the allure of Ironman distance triathlons and who can participate?**

Answer:The allure of Ironman distance triathlons is their undeniable appeal, attracting triathletes from all corners of life, regardless of age, size, or background. Originally seen as a challenge for elite athletes, completing an Ironman is now a cherished experience for many everyday athletes who are willing to meet its demands.

### **2.Question**

**What are the main components of an Ironman event?**

Answer:An Ironman event consists of a 2.4-mile swim, a 112-mile bike ride, and a 26.2-mile run, which together encapsulate both physical endurance and mental resilience.

### **3.Question**

**How does the 80/20 training approach benefit Ironman preparation?**

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Answer: The 80/20 training approach emphasizes quality training over sheer volume, ensuring that participants can complete their Ironman events with a smile rather than in agony. It maximizes the return on training time, allowing athletes to finish strong and enjoy their experience.

#### 4.Question

**What are the differences between the four Ironman training plans?**

Answer: The four Ironman training plans vary by levels designed to accommodate different experience and fitness levels: Level 0 is for first-timers, Level 1 caters to beginners and those seeking a lower volume, Level 2 is for competitive triathletes aiming for personal bests, and Level 3 is targeted at ambitious triathletes looking to excel.

#### 5.Question

**What prerequisites are needed before starting the Ironman Level 0 training plan?**

Answer: Before starting the Ironman Level 0 training plan, participants should be comfortably able to swim and run for

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45 minutes and cycle for 60 minutes, alongside completing at least 3 hours of aerobic exercise over seven days.

### 6.Question

**What mental and physical qualities does completing an Ironman instill in athletes?**

Answer:Completing an Ironman instills unwavering resilience, discipline, and a sense of accomplishment. It transforms the athletes' perceptions of their abilities, heightening their dedication to their physical health and mental fortitude.

### 7.Question

**Why is it important to enjoy the experience of completing an Ironman?**

Answer:Enjoying the experience of completing an Ironman fosters long-lasting memories and encourages a positive relationship with the sport, inspiring athletes to pursue future challenges with enthusiasm instead of viewing them as burdens.

### 8.Question

**How should athletes approach their weekend training**

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## **sessions for an Ironman?**

Answer: Athletes should refer to the guidelines for balancing training on weekends involving both cycling and running, ensuring they incorporate adequate intensity across different workout zones to optimize performance.

## **9.Question**

### **What is the importance of the tapering phase in the Ironman training plan?**

Answer: The tapering phase, which lasts for two weeks, is crucial as it allows the body to recover and adapt from the rigorous training, ensuring athletes are physically and mentally prepared to deliver their best performance on race day.

## **10.Question**

### **In what ways does participating in an Ironman alter one's lifestyle?**

Answer: Participating in an Ironman often transforms an individual's lifestyle, encouraging healthier habits, promoting regular physical activity, and fostering a

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community connection among fellow triathletes who share similar goals and challenges.

## **Chapter 14 | 15 Race Day| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What is the primary goal of pacing in a triathlon race?**

Answer:The primary goal of pacing in a triathlon is to distribute and manage effort across the entire race in such a way that it enables the athlete to finish in the shortest time possible.

### **2.Question**

**Why shouldn't athletes use 80/20 training zones during races?**

Answer:80/20 training zones are too general for racing because they are designed for workouts, which focus on specific training effects, while racing requires precise effort management to achieve optimal finishing times.

### **3.Question**

**What is the best approach to determine optimal pacing during a triathlon?**

Answer:The best approach is to set specific performance

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goals based on training feedback and past race experiences, then create a tailored pacing plan that accounts for the specific race course and conditions.

#### 4.Question

**How does perceived effort play a role in race pacing?**

Answer: Perceived effort allows athletes to adjust their work rate during the race, ensuring they do not push too hard early on or slow down unnecessarily later, thus maintaining an effort level that maximizes performance.

#### 5.Question

**What are the key steps to effective triathlon pacing?**

Answer: 1. Set realistic performance goals for each leg of the race. 2. Create a race-specific pacing plan that includes knowledge of the course and conditions. 3. Execute the plan intelligently, using perceived effort to make real-time adjustments.

#### 6.Question

**Why is it important to maintain steady effort levels throughout a triathlon?**

Answer: Maintaining steady effort levels helps athletes

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optimize their performance by avoiding excessive fatigue or leaving energy unutilized at the end, which ultimately impacts their overall completion time.

### 7.Question

**What method can athletes use to set swim pace goals effectively?**

Answer: Athletes can set swim pace goals by conducting a time trial to determine their all-out swim speed and then calculating reasonable goal times by adding 15 percent to this time for the race.

### 8.Question

**What is the significance of understanding personal capacity during training?**

Answer: Understanding and assessing personal capacity during training allows athletes to set realistic and achievable race goals, adapting their pacing strategies to their evolving fitness levels.

### 9.Question

**How can triathletes prepare for unique race conditions?**

Answer: Triathletes should research the race course, possibly

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train on it, gather information from previous participants, and adjust their pacing plans according to expected conditions like terrain and weather.

### 10.Question

**What lesson can be learned from pacing errors in previous races?**

Answer:Pacing errors in previous races provide invaluable learning opportunities, enabling athletes to identify what went wrong and refine their pacing strategies for future events.

## Chapter 15 | Appendix A: 80/20 Swimming Workouts| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the purpose of Swim Recovery workouts in triathlon training?**

Answer:Swim Recovery workouts are aimed at accelerating recovery after intense training sessions, such as challenging runs or bike rides. They allow athletes to maintain a training stimulus while promoting active recovery through light swimming,

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enabling them to stay in Zone 1 and mix in various stroke drills for technique enhancement.

## 2.Question

**How do Swim Foundation workouts help triathletes?**

Answer:Swim Foundation workouts serve two important functions: they help maintain the optimal 80/20 intensity balance in swim training and allow athletes to focus on form and technique through long, steady efforts at a comfortable pace, particularly in Zone 2.

## 3.Question

**What are Swim Aerobic Intervals designed to achieve?**

Answer:Swim Aerobic Intervals are intended to enable athletes to swim long distances within Zone 2 without the monotony of continuous swimming. These workouts are especially beneficial for half and full Ironman training, allowing simulation of race-day intensity.

## 4.Question

**Why are Swim Cruise Intervals considered a 'secret weapon' for triathletes?**

Answer:Swim Cruise Intervals are deemed a 'secret weapon'

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because they effectively increase critical velocity when performed in Zone 3. They also provide a unique opportunity to test and refine swim technique under a specific effort level, making them critical for improving overall swim performance.

### 5.Question

**What common mistake should athletes avoid during Swim Tempo sessions?**

Answer: Athletes should avoid starting too fast during Swim Tempo sessions, which can lead to fading as they tire.

Instead, they should begin at their Zone 3 critical velocity or slightly below and maintain proper form throughout the workout.

### 6.Question

**How can Swim Mixed Intervals provide variety in training?**

Answer: Swim Mixed Intervals combine efforts across almost all intensity zones in a single session, making them a well-rounded fitness builder. They allow for variety through

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the incorporation of different strokes, breaking the monotony of traditional slow-and-steady swims.

### 7.Question

**What is the significance of the Swim Time Trial workout in triathlon training plans?**

Answer:The Swim Time Trial workout is important for reestablishing swim zones and keeping fitness levels current throughout the training process. It is built into training plans to assess performance and ensure athletes are adapting as they progress.

### 8.Question

**How do Swim Taper sessions prepare athletes for competition?**

Answer:Swim Taper sessions are designed to reduce training workload before competition, eliminating fatigue while including just enough hard work to keep athletes sharp and race-ready for their upcoming events.

### 9.Question

**What role does maintaining proper form play in high-intensity swim training?**

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Answer: Maintaining proper form during high-intensity swim training, such as in Swim Short Intervals, is crucial. It ensures that athletes can sustain their speed even as they experience mounting fatigue, ultimately leading to better performance outcomes.

### 10.Question

**In what ways can triathletes use Swim Recovery workouts creatively?**

Answer: Triathletes can creatively use Swim Recovery workouts by breaking them into smaller segments, incorporating rest, and integrating various drills. This flexibility allows athletes to adapt the workouts to their needs while still benefiting from the recovery and technique focus.

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## Chapter 16 | Appendix B: 80/20 Cycling Workouts| Q&A

### 1.Question

**How can cyclists effectively incorporate recovery rides into their training without losing fitness?**

Answer:Cycling Recovery rides (CRe) should be performed at a gentle, steady Zone 1 effort to maintain fitness while promoting regeneration.

Athletes must avoid group rides that may push them beyond the intended intensity. These recovery sessions should be spaced between more intense or longer workouts to allow for optimal recovery.

### 2.Question

**What key mindset is necessary for success during the Cycling Foundation workout?**

Answer:Discipline and humility are essential when executing the Cycling Foundation (CF) workout. Cyclists must resist the temptation to exceed Zone 2 intensity, even when feeling good, and must embrace slower paces to ensure they are maximizing their endurance training.

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### 3.Question

**What does the Cycling Aerobic Intervals workout aim to prepare athletes for?**

Answer:The Cycling Aerobic Intervals (CAe) workout primarily prepares athletes for the specific intensity and stress they will experience during half and full Ironman races, with the intervals conducted at the expected intensity for those long-distance events.

### 4.Question

**What is the importance of the Cycling Cruise Intervals workout in a triathlete's training?**

Answer:Cycling Cruise Intervals (CCI) significantly enhance muscular endurance, which is vital for maintaining performance over long distances in triathlons. These intervals are suitable for all triathlon distances and should be performed steadily in Zone 3 for optimal results.

### 5.Question

**How can the Cycling Tempo workout benefit a triathlete's race performance?**

Answer:The Cycling Tempo (CT) workout develops

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muscular endurance and simulates the pacing required during Sprint and Olympic races. This workout is challenging due to its extended Zone 3 segments, promoting effective race day strategies.

## 6.Question

**What does the Cycling Fast Finish workout aim to enhance, and why is it unique?**

Answer:The Cycling Fast Finish (CFF) workout focuses on building resilience, allowing athletes to sustain high intensity even after earlier efforts in a session. Performing this workout cultivates the ability to excel while riding on fatigued legs, simulating the end of a race.

## 7.Question

**Why might Cycling Mixed Intervals be deemed necessary for certain athletes despite their difficulty?**

Answer:Cycling Mixed Intervals (CMIs) are critical for increasing lactate threshold and aerobic capacity, yielding substantial benefits in sustainable output. While they are grueling, the enhancements they offer can lead to significant

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race improvements, particularly for Sprint and Olympic-distance competitors.

### 8.Question

**What role does the Cycling Anaerobic Intervals workout play in a triathlete's training regimen?**

Answer:Cycling Anaerobic Intervals (CAn) are essential for boosting aerobic capacity (VO<sub>2</sub>max), which is linked to better race performance. Properly executed, these high-intensity intervals enhance overall movement economy, a key component for endurance athletes.

### 9.Question

**How does the Cycling Speed Play workout differ from typical interval workouts?**

Answer:Cycling Speed Play (CSP) incorporates longer Zone 4 intervals with shorter recoveries, which is particularly tricky as pushing too hard can lead to failure in completing the intended intensity. This workout emphasizes the importance of maintaining efforts while managing recovery.

### 10.Question

**What is the purpose of Brick workouts in triathlon**

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**training?**

Answer:Brick workouts simulate actual race conditions by alternating between cycling and running. This training format enhances the transition skills triathletes need for race day and better prepares them for the compounded fatigue experienced in a race.

## **Chapter 17 | Appendix C: 80/20 Running Workouts| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What is the purpose of Running Recovery (RRe)?**

Answer:Running Recovery (RRe) provides a gentle aerobic training stimulus while ensuring recovery from previous intensive workouts. It is essential to maintain a low intensity (Zone 1) to conserve energy for upcoming harder training sessions.

### **2.Question**

**Why is Running Foundation (RF) important in triathlon training?**

Answer:Running Foundation (RF) is crucial because it builds aerobic capacity at a pace below the ventilatory threshold.

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Holding back in this workout may contribute more to performance improvements than any other training change, akin to eating your 'vegetables' for long-term nutritional benefits.

### 3.Question

**How should an athlete approach Running Aerobic Intervals (RAe)?**

Answer: Athletes should aim for the intensity they expect in their next half or full Ironman, starting at the lower end of Zone 2 for beginners and progressing to the upper end for advanced runners. This specificity of intensity helps prepare for race conditions.

### 4.Question

**What benefit do Running Cruise Intervals (RCI) provide?**

Answer: Running Cruise Intervals (RCI) help maintain and improve lactate threshold pace, allowing triathletes to achieve faster run splits in races by training the body to sustain higher intensities over longer periods.

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## 5.Question

**How does Running Tempo (RT) contribute to triathlon training?**

Answer:Running Tempo (RT) allows athletes to simulate race intensity and validate their lactate threshold, ensuring they can sustain competitive speeds during actual events.

## 6.Question

**What is the unique benefit of Running Fast Finish (RFF) workouts?**

Answer:Running Fast Finish (RFF) workouts develop the ability to maintain speed even when fatigued, which is vital for finishing strong in triathlons.

## 7.Question

**What distinguishes Running Hill Repeats (RHR) from other workouts?**

Answer:Running Hill Repeats (RHR) focus on building power and efficiency in stride through intense, short Zone 5 efforts, which are essential for improving overall running performance.

## 8.Question

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## **What should athletes keep in mind during Running Mixed Intervals (RMI)?**

Answer: During Running Mixed Intervals (RMI), athletes need to manage discomfort without reaching the point of agony and should remember that while pain is temporary, race performance is permanently recorded.

### **9.Question**

## **How does Running Anaerobic Intervals (RAn) influence an athlete's performance?**

Answer: Running Anaerobic Intervals (RAn) boost aerobic capacity and running economy, laying a foundation for improved performance in race-specific runs later in the training cycle.

### **10.Question**

## **What role does Running Taper (RTa) play in the weeks leading up to races?**

Answer: Running Taper (RTa) helps athletes stay sharp with minimal intensity to prevent fatigue, ensuring they're prepared for race day while allowing for adequate recovery.

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# 80/20 Triathlon Quiz and Test

[Check the Correct Answer on Bookey Website](#)

## Chapter 1 | 1 The Most Effective Way to Train| Quiz and Test

- 1.The 80/20 Rule states that elite athletes train 80% of the time at high intensity.
- 2.Training specificity, volume, and intensity are crucial components of an effective triathlon training strategy.
- 3.Billy Hafferty's performance improved when he switched from the 80/20 training regimen to a higher intensity training regimen.

## Chapter 2 | 2 Going Slower to Get Faster| Quiz and Test

- 1.In an experiment, elite triathlete Ainhua Murúa spent 83% of her training below the lactate threshold, highlighting the success of the 80/20 Rule.
- 2.All recreational triathletes successfully adhere to the 80/20 training principle as elite athletes do.

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3.The 'week of slow' is a suggested strategy for athletes to transition into the 80/20 training principle by focusing on low-intensity workouts.

## **Chapter 3 | 3 The Science of 80/20 Training| Quiz and Test**

- 1.The 80/20 training model claims that 80% of workouts should be low-intensity and 20% should be moderate and high-intensity combined.
- 2.High-intensity training should make up the majority of an athlete's workout regimen according to the 80/20 training model.
- 3.Low-intensity workouts are essential for improving aerobic capacity and technique refinement during triathlon training.

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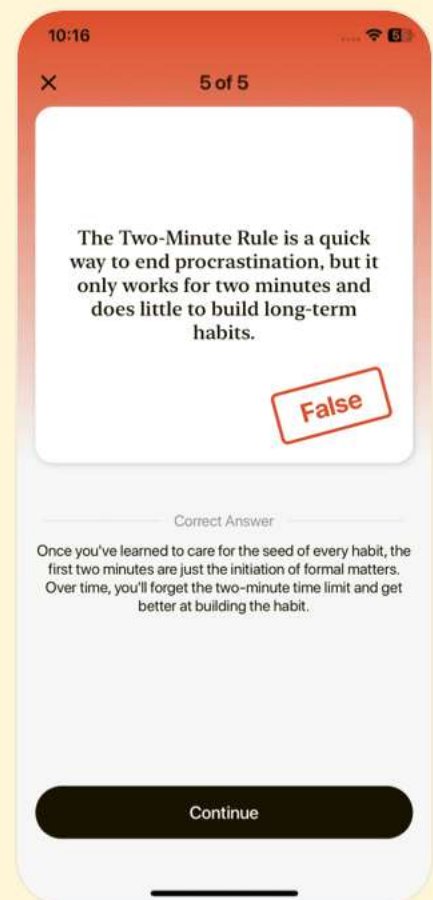
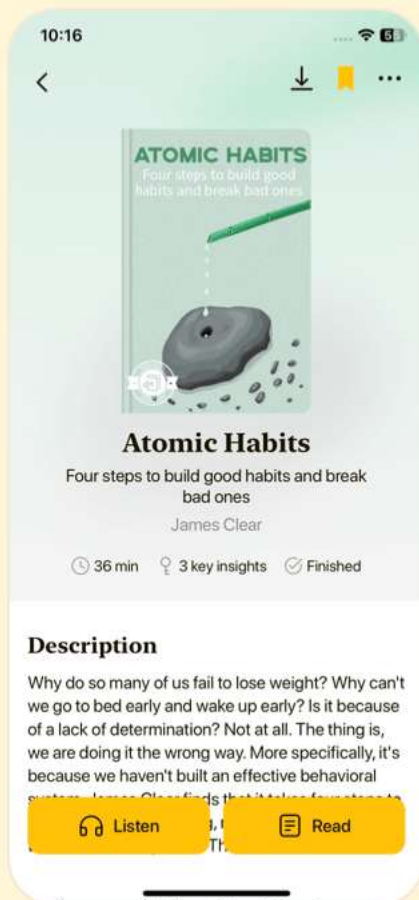


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## Chapter 4 | 4 Swimming the 80/20 Way| Quiz and Test

1. Swimming is usually the most comfortable discipline for triathletes compared to running and biking.
2. The 80/20 approach recommends that 80% of swimming training be done at low intensity.
3. Lactate threshold (LT) is the intensity level at which lactate begins to accumulate in the bloodstream, it represents the highest sustainable effort for approximately 30 minutes.

## Chapter 5 | 5 Cycling the 80/20 Way| Quiz and Test

1. Cycling is the least crucial discipline in triathlons, taking up less time than swimming and running combined.
2. Determining your intensity zones through lactate threshold testing is the first step to applying the 80/20 Rule in cycling.
3. Power metrics are more variable and less reliable than heart rate for measuring cycling output.

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## Chapter 6 | 6 Running the 80/20 Way| Quiz and Test

1. Running is less challenging than swimming or cycling.
2. To find your lactate threshold heart rate (LTHR), you need to maintain a high pace for 30 minutes and record your average heart rate.
3. 80/20 training ratios are not important for running workouts.

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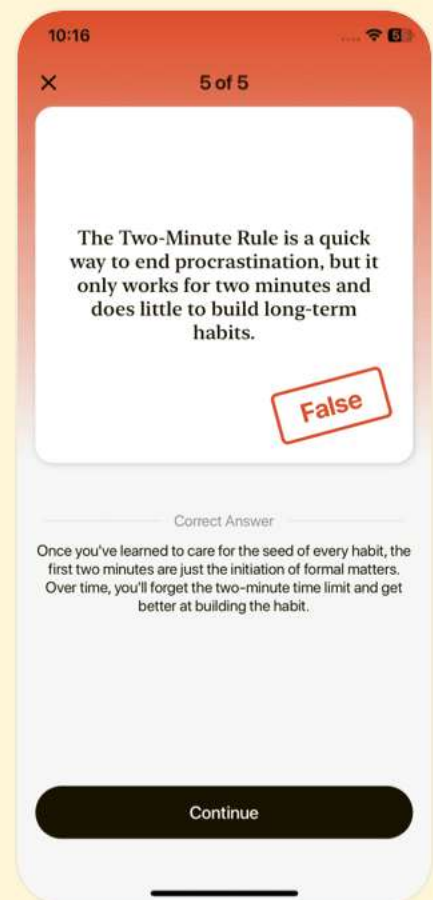
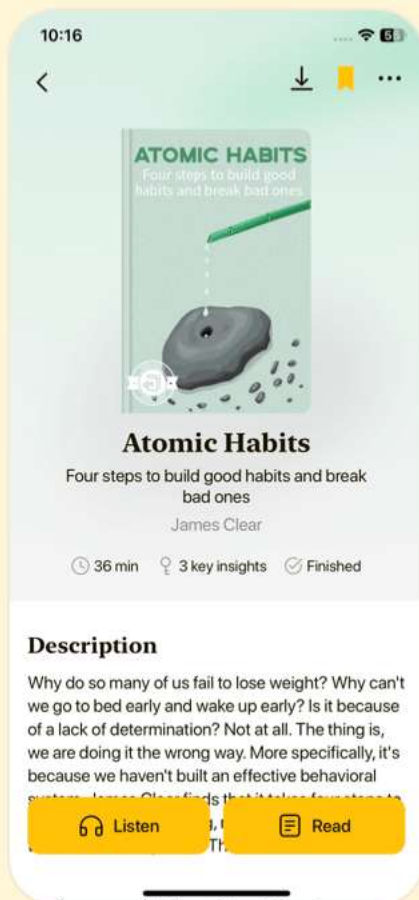


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## **Chapter 7 | 7 Strength, Flexibility, and Mobility Training| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Strength training can help prevent common overuse injuries in triathletes.
- 2.Flexibility refers to the active range of motion of joints, unlike mobility which is passive.
- 3.Finding time for strength, mobility, and flexibility training is easy for athletes with busy schedules.

## **Chapter 8 | 8 Getting Started with 80/20 Training| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Effective triathlon training does not require a structured plan.
- 2.Every third or fourth week should be scheduled as a recovery week to help manage fatigue and injury risk.
- 3.Most triathletes can fully rely on ready-made training plans without understanding the fundamentals of training design.

## **Chapter 9 | 9 Introduction to 80/20 Training Plans| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Monday is generally a rest day for all triathlon training plans.

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2. Each training plan for triathlons provides the distribution of low versus moderate/high intensity for the week.
3. You should always perform the bike workout before running if they are scheduled on the same day, regardless of intensity.

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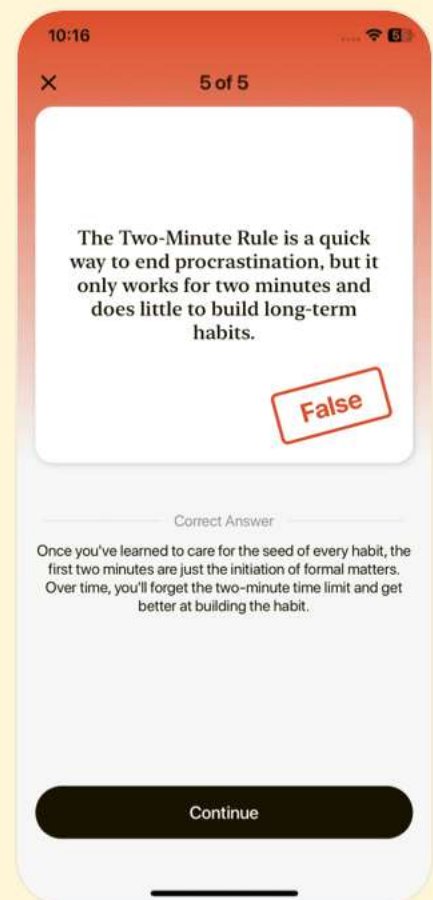
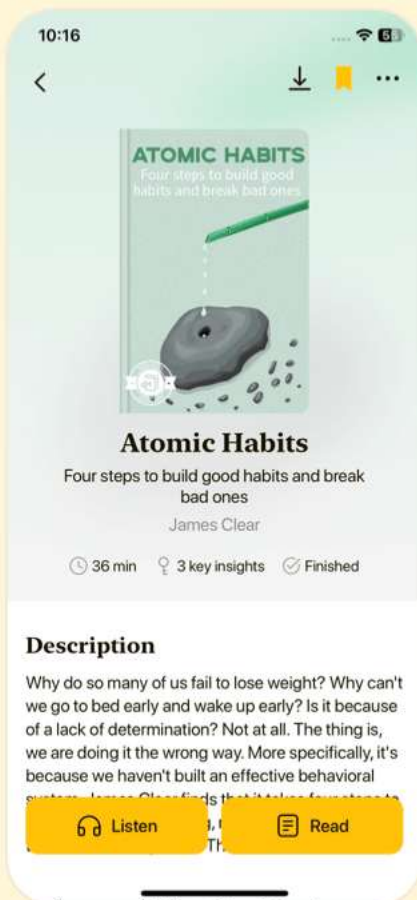


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## **Chapter 10 | 10 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Sprint Distance| Quiz and Test**

- 1.The sprint triathlon is comprised of a 0.5-mile swim, a 12-mile bike ride, and a 3-mile run.
- 2.The Level 0 training plan is designed for experienced triathletes with prior sprint racing experience.
- 3.All training plans for the sprint triathlon include a two-week taper period at the end.

## **Chapter 11 | 11 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Olympic Distance| Quiz and Test**

- 1.The Olympic distance triathlon consists of a 2.5 km swim, 40 km bike, and a 10 km run.
- 2.The Level 0 training plan targets first-time Olympic event finishers with a weekly volume starting at 4 hours.
- 3.The Level 3 training plan is designed for beginners who have not completed any endurance events before.

## **Chapter 12 | 12 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Half Ironman Distance| Quiz and Test**

- 1.The half Ironman is a 70.3-mile event that appeals only to seasoned athletes and not newcomers.

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2. The training levels for a half Ironman range from 17 to 20 weeks in length.
3. The specific phase of training may shift the intensity ratio closer to 85/15 during workouts.

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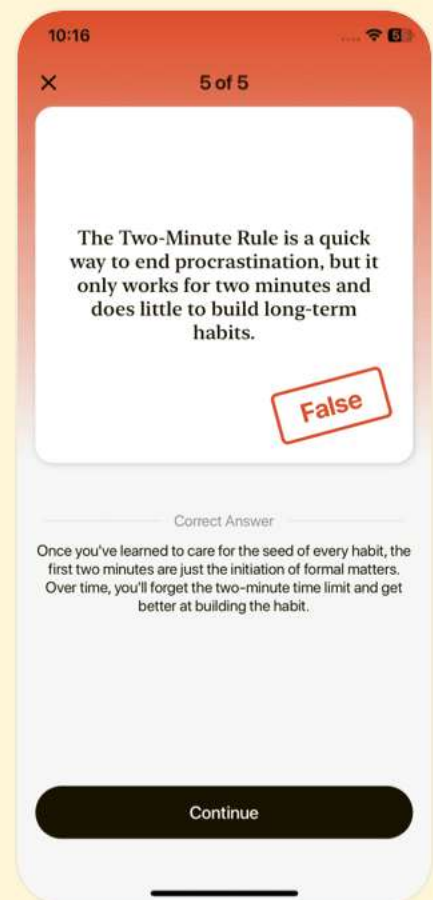
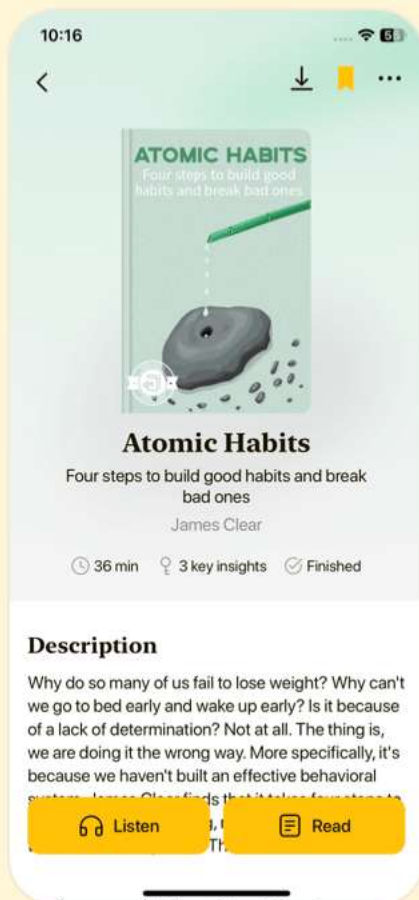


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## **Chapter 13 | 13 80/20 Triathlon Training Plans: Ironman Distance| Quiz and Test**

- 1.The Ironman distance was first established in 1980.
- 2.Level 3 of the Ironman training plans is for first-time Ironman participants.
- 3.The 80/20 training approach emphasizes finishing an Ironman with pride and energy instead of exhaustion.

## **Chapter 14 | 15 Race Day| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Intensity zones from training are too broad for race conditions and not useful for racing objectives.
- 2.Swimming at 90-95% of max effort can enhance overall race performance.
- 3.Consistent pacing in cycling is linked to better performance outcomes in triathlons.

## **Chapter 15 | Appendix A: 80/20 Swimming Workouts| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Swim Recovery workouts are designed to help athletes recover without a major fitness build.

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2. Swim Tempo workouts are primarily focused on increasing endurance in Zone 1.
3. Swim Time Trials are used for assessing training zones and tracking fitness improvements.

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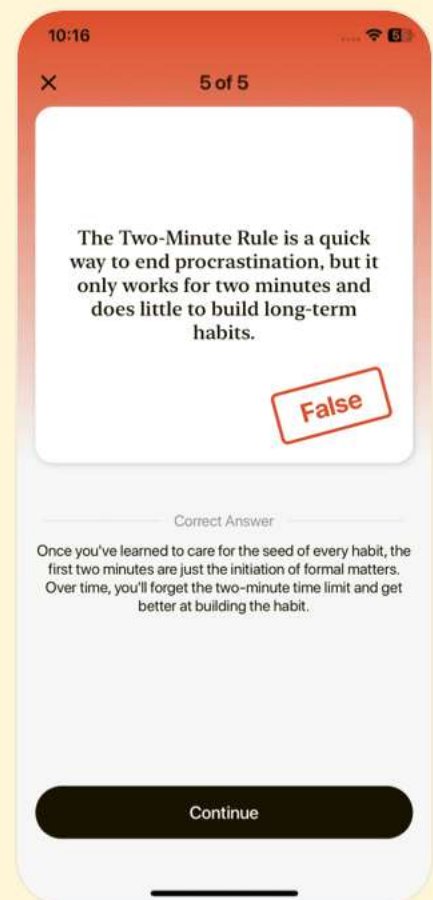
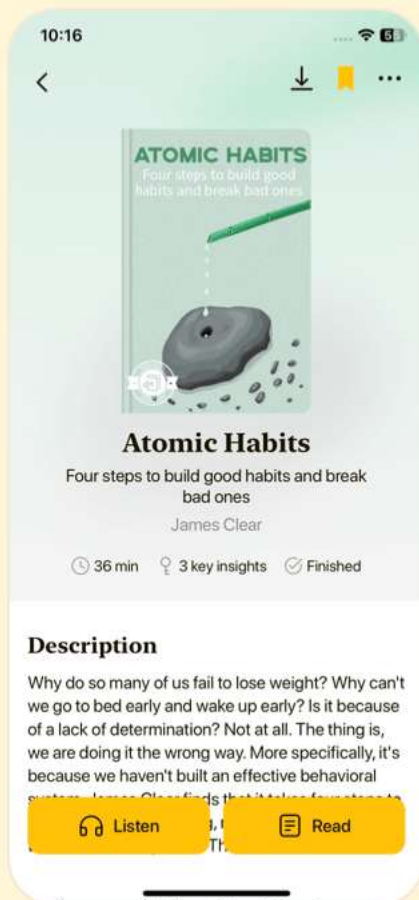


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## **Chapter 16 | Appendix B: 80/20 Cycling Workouts| Quiz and Test**

1. High-Intensity Intervals play a significant role in managing workout intensity in cycling sessions.
2. Cycling Recovery (CRe) workouts are best performed in groups to maintain the required intensity.
3. Brick workouts help athletes master transitions between cycling and running while building overall fitness.

## **Chapter 17 | Appendix C: 80/20 Running Workouts| Quiz and Test**

1. Running Recovery (RRe) is performed at high intensity to ensure effective recovery from previous workouts.
2. Running Foundation (RF) should be performed slightly below the ventilatory threshold for optimal performance enhancement.
3. Running Hill Repeats (RHR) are measured by heart rate to gauge intensity accurately.

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